



**The California State University**  
ACCESSIBLE TECHNOLOGY INITIATIVE

## **Digital Content Remediation Prioritization Framework**

|                                                                                  |           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Digital Content Remediation Prioritization Framework.....</b>                 | <b>1</b>  |
| <b>Executive Summary .....</b>                                                   | <b>4</b>  |
| <b>Objective .....</b>                                                           | <b>5</b>  |
| <b>How to Use This Document.....</b>                                             | <b>5</b>  |
| <b>Start Where You Are (Pathways by Readiness Level) .....</b>                   | <b>6</b>  |
| <b>1. Inventory &amp; Assessment .....</b>                                       | <b>6</b>  |
| 1.1 Establishing the Baseline .....                                              | 6         |
| 1.2 Stakeholder Identification & Partnership Development.....                    | 6         |
| 1.3 Resource Inventory & Cost Analysis.....                                      | 8         |
| 1.4 Gap Analysis & Review of Existing Remediation Practices .....                | 8         |
| 1.5 Prioritization of Courses & Instructional Materials Remediation .....        | 8         |
| 1.6 Source of Materials, Roles and Responsibilities: .....                       | 9         |
| 1.7 Archiving Courses to Reduce Remediation Workload .....                       | 9         |
| <b>2. Awareness Campaign and Communication Process for LMS Remediation .....</b> | <b>10</b> |
| 2.1 Faculty Awareness and Engagement .....                                       | 10        |
| 2.2 Campus Messaging and Communication Toolkits .....                            | 12        |
| 2.3 Establish Accessibility Champions.....                                       | 13        |
| 2.4 Leverage LMS Accessibility Reporting Data .....                              | 14        |
| <b>3. Developing Capacity for Remediation Workflows .....</b>                    | <b>17</b> |
| 3.1. Student Labor as a Remediation Force .....                                  | 17        |
| 3.2 Calculating Throughput .....                                                 | 18        |
| 3.3 Leveraging Vendors for Scalable Remediation and Workflow Continuity .....    | 20        |
| <b>4. Whole Course Remediation Workflow and Process.....</b>                     | <b>20</b> |
| 4.1. Service Request Form and Process Initiation .....                           | 21        |
| 4.2. Remediation Workflow Task Management .....                                  | 22        |
| 4.3. Canvas Course Preparation .....                                             | 25        |
| 4.4 Remediation Tasks.....                                                       | 26        |
| 4.5 Returning Accessible Courses to Instructors.....                             | 29        |
| <b>5. On-Demand Remediation .....</b>                                            | <b>30</b> |
| 5.1. Request Form and File Submission Process .....                              | 30        |
| 5.2 Task Management for One-Demand Workflow.....                                 | 31        |
| 5.3. Task Assignment for Urgent Requests .....                                   | 31        |
| 5.4. Review of Content and Escalation of Complex Files .....                     | 31        |
| <b>6. Remediating Web, Mobile App, and Public-Facing Content .....</b>           | <b>32</b> |
| 6.1 Inventory and Scope of Public-Facing Content .....                           | 32        |
| 6.2 Prioritization Framework for Public-Facing Remediation .....                 | 32        |
| 6.3 Staffing and Workflow Considerations .....                                   | 33        |
| 6.4 Roadmap Development and Compliance Alignment .....                           | 33        |
| 6.5 Ongoing Maintenance and Monitoring .....                                     | 33        |
| <b>7. Optimizing Digital Accessibility.....</b>                                  | <b>34</b> |
| 7.1 Post Remediation Maintenance .....                                           | 34        |
| 7.2 Course Design and Curriculum Innovation.....                                 | 35        |
| <b>10. Recommended Tools &amp; Services (LEON) .....</b>                         | <b>35</b> |
| <b>11. Quick Start Guides .....</b>                                              | <b>38</b> |
| Beginner's Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework.....  | 39        |
| 2. Building Awareness and Campus Engagement .....                                | 39        |
| 3. Start Small with Capacity Building.....                                       | 39        |



|                                                                                                  |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| 4. Run Your First Whole-Course Remediation .....                                                 | 40        |
| 5. Offer On-Demand Support .....                                                                 | 40        |
| 6. Proactively Maintain Accessibility .....                                                      | 40        |
| 7. Track What You're Doing.....                                                                  | 41        |
| <b>Intermediate Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework.....</b>         | <b>41</b> |
| 1. Strengthening Your Needs Assessment and Planning .....                                        | 41        |
| 2. Expanding Communication and Faculty Engagement.....                                           | 42        |
| 3. Building and Managing Your Remediation Team .....                                             | 42        |
| 4. Managing the Course Remediation Process .....                                                 | 42        |
| 5. Handling On-Demand and Urgent Requests .....                                                  | 43        |
| 6. Monitoring Your Impact and Improving Over Time .....                                          | 43        |
| <b>Advanced Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework.....</b>             | <b>44</b> |
| 1. Strategic Needs Assessment & Prioritization .....                                             | 44        |
| 2. Communication at Scale .....                                                                  | 44        |
| 3. Expanding Capacity and Continuity .....                                                       | 45        |
| 4. Advanced Workflow and Automation .....                                                        | 45        |
| 5. Responsive On-Demand Support Infrastructure .....                                             | 45        |
| 6. Monitoring, Metrics, and Continuous Improvement .....                                         | 46        |
| 7. Driving Long-Term Accessibility Culture.....                                                  | 46        |
| <b>Appendix A: Memo: Renewed Campus Commitment: Accessible Technology Initiative (ATI) .....</b> | <b>47</b> |
| <b>Appendix B: Executive-Level Campus Wide Communication .....</b>                               | <b>49</b> |
| <b>Appendix C: College-Level Communication.....</b>                                              | <b>50</b> |
| <b>Appendix D: Communication Toolkits for Chairs and Deans .....</b>                             | <b>52</b> |
| <b>Appendix E: Faculty Outreach Message with Request Form .....</b>                              | <b>56</b> |
| <b>Appendix F: Email Notification for Completion of Service .....</b>                            | <b>57</b> |



## Executive Summary

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The Digital Content Remediation Prioritization Framework is designed to guide California State University (CSU) campuses in effectively prioritizing and expediting the remediation of digital content, ensuring compliance with Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by April 2026. This comprehensive resource provides structured guidelines, actionable strategies, and recommended tools to assist campuses in developing or enhancing their internal accessibility processes. Title II mandates that public institutions ensure equal access to programs, services, and activities, making digital accessibility not only a legal obligation but a critical component of educational equity and inclusion.

The Chancellor's Office ATI is actively supporting this framework by providing targeted funding aligned with the strategies outlined in this document. For most campuses, this funding is intended to support the hiring of student assistants to enhance in-house capacity for digital content remediation. For fiscal year 2024–25, an Interagency Financial Transaction (IFT) was issued to all campuses on Friday, May 16.

### Key components of the framework include:

- **Inventory & Assessment:** Establish baselines, identify stakeholders, conduct resource and gap analyses, and prioritize remediation tasks to address accessibility systematically and efficiently.
- **Awareness and Communication Strategy:** Promoting a campus-wide culture of accessibility through targeted communication campaigns, training sessions, and leveraging faculty champions to foster broad-based engagement and compliance.
- **Capacity Development:** Maximizing campus resources by utilizing student labor, staff training, and strategic vendor partnerships to build scalable, sustainable remediation workflows.
- **Remediation Workflows:** Clearly defined processes for whole-course and on-demand file remediation, supported by efficient task management tools and detailed operational steps to streamline accessibility enhancements.
- **Proactive Accessibility Measures:** Encouraging faculty-led preventive measures and integrating advanced monitoring solutions (e.g., custom dashboards) to maintain accessible course content proactively.
- **Monitoring Progress and KPIs:** Establishing measurable performance indicators and monitoring mechanisms to track remediation effectiveness, drive continuous improvement, and maintain accountability.



This framework not only ensures that CSU campuses meet legal obligations for digital accessibility but also promotes a proactive, inclusive educational environment that benefits all students. The included appendices offer templates, tools, and further resources to expedite the implementation and ongoing management of campus remediation initiatives.

## Objective

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The primary objective of this framework is to provide CSU campuses with a structured, practical guide to systematically remediate digital content and achieve compliance with Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) by April 2026. Specifically, the framework seeks to:

- Equip campuses with actionable strategies for assessing current digital accessibility needs, prioritizing course remediation, and efficiently managing resources.
- Foster widespread campus awareness and active participation through clear, consistent communication and targeted training initiatives.
- Develop scalable, sustainable workflows leveraging campus resources, student workers, and strategic external partnerships.
- Encourage proactive accessibility practices, reducing future remediation demands and maintaining long-term compliance.
- Provide robust monitoring and reporting structures to evaluate progress, inform strategic decision-making, and demonstrate continuous improvement.

This framework supports campuses at any stage of accessibility implementation, facilitating a collaborative, coordinated effort towards creating universally accessible learning environments.

## How to Use This Document

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This framework offers adaptable tools and best practices designed to fit each campus's unique challenges, processes, and resources.

Key suggestions include:

- **Tailored Use Across Units:** Some sections will be more relevant to specific campus units. Distribute the content accordingly and encourage those units to focus on the sections most aligned with their responsibilities.
- **Helpful Companion Resources:** Use the planning checklist and quick start guides—organized by Beginner, Intermediate, and Advanced levels—to support implementation at any stage.
- **Emphasis on Collaboration:** Watch for callouts highlighting the need for cross-division coordination (e.g., partnering with your LMS administrator) to ensure a cohesive approach.



# Start Where You Are (Pathways by Readiness Level)

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This framework is intentionally comprehensive, which can feel overwhelming at first. But you don't need to tackle everything at once. To make it manageable, the guidance is organized into Beginner, Intermediate, and Advanced tracks—each offering practical steps tailored to where your campus is right now. This lets you jump in at the right level, take meaningful action, and build momentum over time. Whether you're just getting started, expanding existing efforts, or refining a well-established program, there's a clear and achievable path forward. Quick reference guides at the end of this document provide a way to navigate this content as a beginner, intermediate, or advanced remediation campus.

Quick reference guides:

- [Beginner](#)
- [Intermediate](#)
- [Advanced](#)

## 1. Inventory & Assessment

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### 1.1 Establishing the Baseline

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Inventory of Existing Content:

- Catalog all types of instructional materials (documents, multimedia, interactive content) used in courses. This can be achieved by leveraging accessibility tools that gather this information in your LMS.
- Review current accessibility metrics (LMS accessibility tool outputs) to determine overall compliance levels.
  - TIP: Set up a schedule to review these metrics quarterly. Reviewing quarterly will allow you to see progress over time and challenges that may be presenting themselves.

Data Collection:

- Gather the following metrics: the number of courses, files, and types of accessibility issues (e.g., missing alt text, improper headings).
- Identify and document existing remediation efforts and historical trends that can inform future needs.

### 1.2 Stakeholder Identification & Partnership Development

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Identify and Map Key Stakeholders:

- Engage senior leadership and executive administrators to secure commitment and formal endorsement of remediation initiatives. An endorsement may include a formal memo establishing or recommitting the campus to ATI efforts.



- Including academic leadership (e.g., college deans, department chairs, and academic technology directors) to ensure remediation efforts are integrated into course planning and delivery.
- Involve IT and digital accessibility teams to review current technical capabilities and determine and document the support needed for remediation workflows.
- Collaborate with disability services and student support offices to understand the unique needs of students and to identify courses where accessibility barriers are most critical.
- Consider external partners such as accessibility consultants and vendors to provide specialized expertise or to support peak remediation periods.

#### Establish Formal Collaboration Structures:

- Form a steering committee or task force with representatives from each key stakeholder group to provide strategic direction and monitor progress.
- Create working groups focused on specific areas, such as technical remediation, faculty training, or budget/resource planning, ensuring that roles and responsibilities are clearly defined.
- Develop regular meeting schedules and communication channels to foster ongoing collaboration and timely issue resolution.

#### Develop Communication Protocols:

- Set up a structured communication plan that includes regular progress updates, shared digital workspaces (e.g., a project management portal or SharePoint site), and clear reporting mechanisms.
- Ensure that communication is transparent and that all stakeholders are kept informed of milestones, challenges, and successes throughout the remediation process.

#### Invest in Training and Capacity Building:

- Organize targeted training sessions for technical staff, faculty, and support personnel to build a shared understanding of accessibility standards and remediation best practices.
- Provide resources such as best practice guides, case studies, and instructional videos to support ongoing learning and process improvement.
- Establish a feedback loop to capture lessons learned and continuously refine the training programs and remediation strategies.

### 1.2.1 Building Relationships

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We cannot stress enough the importance of building relationships as a key element to a successful digital content remediation program. Accessibility is not a one-person job; it requires collaboration across departments, leadership support, and shared responsibility. Strong relationships help build the trust, communication, and coordination needed to make meaningful and lasting progress. To check your campus relationships, we ask you to ask yourselves these questions related to ATI and the upcoming Title II changes:

- When was the last commitment to ATI email sent to all campus?



- Example: [Appendix A](#)
- Has your campus sent out information on the upcoming Title II changes?
- Does a steering committee with campus-wide representation exist?
- Is your annual plan updated with input from campus collaborators?

## 1.3 Resource Inventory & Cost Analysis

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### Current Staffing & Capabilities:

- Document existing student assistant and staff capabilities in digital remediation.
  - Gather any remediation data available, which could include file remediation time to completion averages etc.
- Evaluate current training programs and identify any gaps in knowledge related to accessibility.

### Budget & Cost Considerations:

- Analyze and document current spending on remediation efforts (e.g., software licenses, work-study funds).
- Forecast additional resource needs, including potential budget increases for staffing or outsourcing complex tasks.
  - TIP: Create measure of success for any resource requests.

## 1.4 Gap Analysis & Review of Existing Remediation Practices

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### Assessment of Current Processes:

- Review how current remediation workflows (centralized vs. decentralized) address accessibility issues in instructional materials.
- Compare existing practices to documented best practices found in this framework.

### Identification of Gaps:

- Develop a gap analysis sheet that highlights discrepancies between current practices and the desired accessibility standard.
- Highlight specific areas within instructional materials (e.g., alt text, heading structures, multimedia captions) that require targeted improvement. More information about how to make progress in this area can be below in section 1.5.

## 1.5 Prioritization of Courses & Instructional Materials Remediation

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### Criteria for Prioritization:

- Use metrics such as enrollment size, course impact (e.g., GE, core curriculum, electives), and frequency of accessibility issues to rank courses.
- Prioritize courses with high-impact instructional materials that directly affect large numbers of students or those with significant accessibility challenges.





- Focus on courses with high rates of student withdrawal, failure, or incompletes, as these may correlate with unaddressed accessibility barriers.
- Give precedence to courses required for graduation or major progression, particularly those acting as gatekeepers to advanced study.
- Prioritize courses with a history of student accommodation requests, indicating known accessibility challenges.
- Consider instructor readiness and willingness to engage in remediation efforts to maximize short-term impact.
- Elevate courses with digital materials that are reused across multiple sections or semesters, amplifying the return on remediation efforts.
- Use data from accessibility audits or LMS reports to identify courses with the most complex or numerous digital accessibility issues.

#### Pilot Selection & Phased Remediation Approach:

- Identify a small group of “jumbo” or high-visibility courses to pilot remediation processes, allowing for refinement before broader rollout.
- Develop a timeline for a semester-based remediation cycle that addresses both whole-course and “just-in-time” needs.

#### Instructional Materials Focus:

- Ensure that the prioritization process includes an in-depth review of teaching materials (e.g., lecture slides, syllabi, multimedia) with specific checkpoints for common accessibility issues.
- Leverage accessible syllabus templates.

## 1.6 Source of Materials, Roles and Responsibilities:

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- Ensure there is an understanding of different types of remediation structures that exist on campuses with the example being disability services offices vs. remediation work for the web or proactive remediation of course materials.
  - Remediation efforts for accommodation tend to come from disability services offices and are considered reactive.
  - Content remediation completed before an accommodation request is considered proactive.
- Publisher and vendor provided materials should be made accessible by the publisher or vendor. Remember that as part of the Title II changes, campuses are in fact responsible for digital content procured through a vendor.
  - TIP: Faculty have great leverage in making this request when it pertains to supplemental instructional materials from publishers.
- Instructor curated and/or authored materials should be the responsibility of the instructor to make accessible or request campus support in making them accessible.

## 1.7 Archiving Courses to Reduce Remediation Workload

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- Develop a process to limit access to past, unused, and/or abandoned courses.



- Old courses not widely available to enrolled students and/or the campus community should not require remediation once archived.
- Users with the role of Teacher may retain access, but only to recover a course. A recovered course would then need to comply with accessibility standards when made available to students and the campus community.
- Two types of Canvas courses will require distinct archival processes: (1) matriculated courses associated with an academic term and (2) campus community courses not connected to an academic term (e.g., first-year student orientation, graduate student resource course).
- Control availability of matriculated courses through Canvas Course Terms.
- Community Courses will require closer monitoring. Staff overseeing a first-year student orientation course may forget to conclude the course after the close of the academic year.

### Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 1)

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- Generate baseline accessibility data using LMS tools such as Ally or UDOIT.
- Identify and convene key campus stakeholders (e.g., LMS Admin, Disability Services, Instructional Design).
- Inventory staff capacity, software tools, and existing remediation efforts.
- Conduct a gap analysis comparing current accessibility practices to WCAG standards.
- Develop a prioritization rubric to identify high-need courses and materials.

## 2. Awareness Campaign and Communication Process for LMS Remediation

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A well-defined Awareness Campaign and Communication Process is critical for successfully implementing whole-course digital content remediation. By systematically educating faculty, staff, and administrators about the importance of digital accessibility, campuses can cultivate broad-based support and ensure consistent engagement in remediation efforts. Precise, targeted messaging tailored to each stakeholder group increases buy-in, helps overcome resistance to new processes, and fosters a campus-wide culture of inclusivity.

Furthermore, an intentional communication plan accelerates collaboration and minimizes confusion by outlining how and when information is shared, whom to contact for guidance, and where to find resources and training. Through regular updates—via emails, workshops, departmental meetings, or newsletters—campus leaders can reinforce Title II ADA compliance's urgency and legal requirements, encourage proactive remediation, and celebrate wins to build momentum. Ultimately, a robust awareness and communication strategy not only facilitates smoother day-to-day operations but also ensures sustainability and accountability, allowing the CSU campus community to work cohesively toward a universally accessible learning environment.

### 2.1 Faculty Awareness and Engagement

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Instructors create the vast majority of materials stored in the LMS. Instructors are uniquely positioned to identify which materials they plan to use and share with students. Their active engagement and cooperation are essential—remediation efforts are unlikely to succeed without them.

To support this, the awareness and communication campaign should focus on helping faculty understand the following:

- Digital accessibility as an issue of equity



- Why their input is essential in identifying materials they plan to continue using
- The remediation timeline and what to expect
- The types of remediation being performed on their instructional materials
- Which accessibility fixes are their responsibility
- How and why remediation team members may contact them with questions or requests.

### 2.1.1. Points of Engagement

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With ongoing and long-term remediation efforts, the campus should consider the multiple points of faculty engagement in the process. Engagement may occur periodically as part of preparation for an upcoming term.

Faculty may engage with remediation efforts in the following ways:

- Receive and read a campus-wide announcement.
- Attend a Q&A session or training on digital accessibility.
- Complete the remediation request form in a timely fashion.
- Submit a course they plan to use in a future term.
- Respond to requests from the remediation team.
- Make use of and load the remediated course into the live course section.

Maintain engagement and responsiveness among faculty through steady and predictable communication. Send several rounds of communication announcing the availability of remediation services. Send confirmation emails and status updates after a course is submitted for remediation.

Request assistance from department and college leaders in amplifying messaging to instructors. Chairs and deans may also help follow up with instructors who have not responded to messaging.

### 2.1.2. Addressing Questions and Concerns

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To assist faculty in navigating the remediation process, consider offering Q&A sessions and/or digital accessibility office hours. Connect with stakeholders in IT (ATI), Academic Technology, Faculty Development, and/or Instructional Design to schedule and offer sessions.

Consider the following when offering Q&A sessions:

- Although an FAQ webpage could answer many common questions, a live session can help identify unknown concerns or issues.
- Offer multiple opportunities to attend, with sessions lasting no more than 45 minutes.
- Frame digital accessibility as an equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging issue.
- Show the steps to request the service.
- Emphasize the skill and technical expertise of the remediation team and the value of the service.
- Discuss the timeline and the importance of taking advantage of it early.

Consider the following when providing accessibility during office hours:

- Weekly office hours could require more staffing than Q&A sessions.
- Staff office hours with student assistants but provide a means for SAs to reach an on-call full-time staff member for escalations.
- Differentiate office hours by providing informal consultations to instructors seeking advice on digital accessibility and answering common questions about remediation services.



## 2.2 Campus Messaging and Communication Toolkits

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To announce the availability of new digital accessibility remediation services, an executive-level stakeholder should send a campus-wide communication to faculty and staff. As remediation often involves instructional materials, the provost is well-positioned to send the first announcement ([Appendix B](#)).

College deans and department chairs may amplify the provost's message in college and department-specific messaging ([Appendix C](#)). Prepare communication toolkits for college leaders and department chairs that provide sample language and talking points to encourage the use of the new services ([Appendix D](#)).

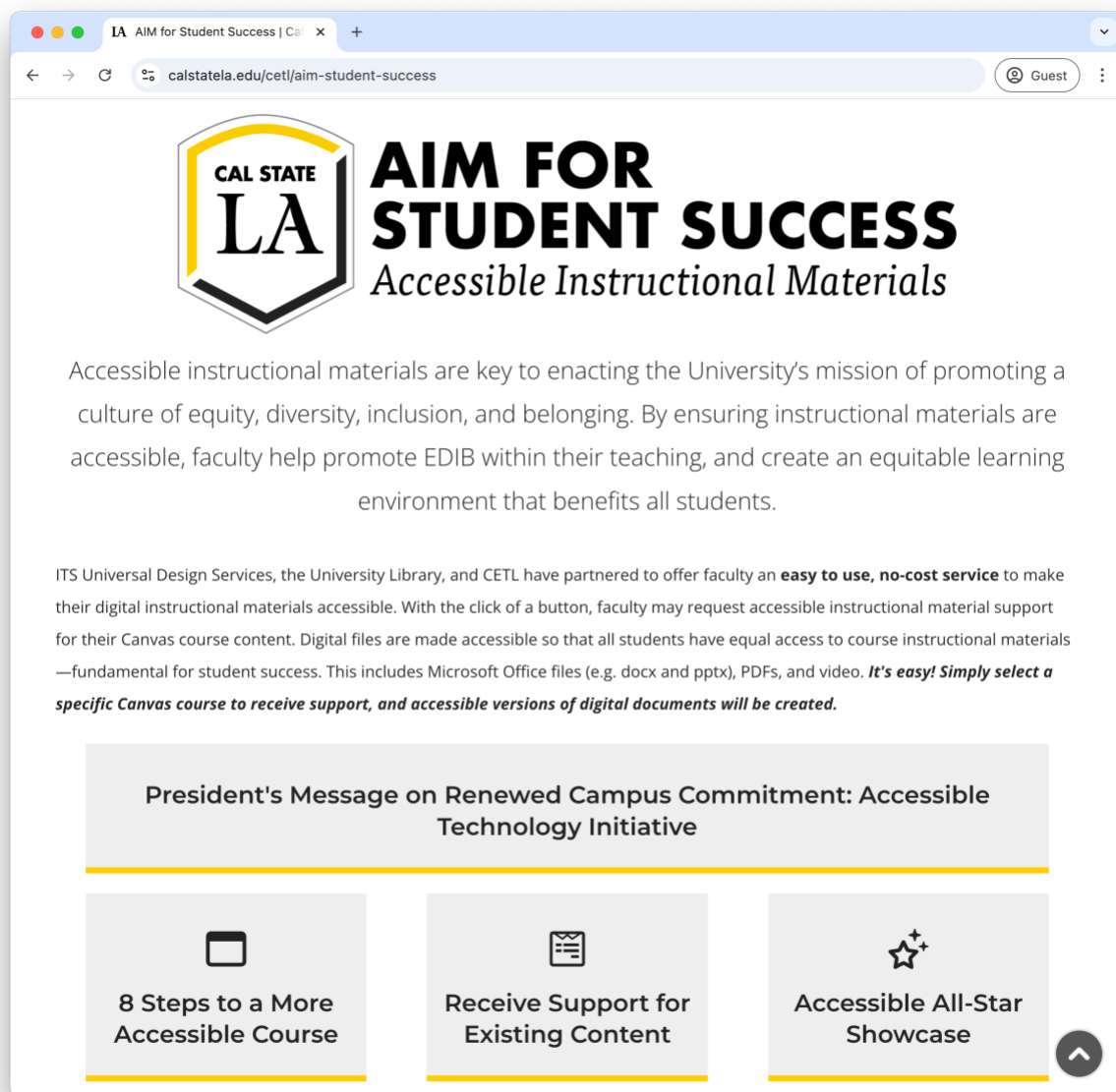
Consider the following when coordinating campus messaging:

- Draft announcement language in consultation with strategic communications professionals (provost or president's office staff).
- Clearly indicate the timeline and deadlines for utilizing the service.
- Describe eligibility and course prioritization, if any.
- Coordinate with college leaders to ensure timely coordination of complimentary college level messaging.

### 2.2.1. Web Presence and Services Hub

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Create and maintain a webpage to hold all critical information related to the new remediation services. Create a straightforward hub to quickly access service request forms, training sign-ups or Q&A sessions, and FAQs.



**A single webpage offers faculty and staff a one-stop hub to access digital remediation services, support, and training.**

## 2.3 Establish Accessibility Champions

Working with academic affairs partners (e.g., faculty development center, office of diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging), identify and retain faculty to serve as accessibility champions. Champions can assist with college, department, and individual instructor outreach.

Consider the following when establishing accessibility champions:

- Fund a dedicated faculty fellowship for digital accessibility.
- Expand the scope of existing equity or student success faculty champions to include accessibility.
- Prepare communication toolkits and presentations for use by champions in their outreach efforts.

- Ensure champions are familiar with digital accessibility processes and services.
- Request champions attend Q&A sessions, present to the academic senate, and make visits to college and/or department meetings.

## 2.4 Leverage LMS Accessibility Reporting Data

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Key stakeholders may wish to understand the scale of the work required to address digital content accessibility in the LMS. In communicating with stakeholders, share accessibility reporting data where appropriate.

Prepare reports from data collected by accessibility reporting tools (e.g., Ally, UDOIT). These tools can assess content and provide a course score (expressed as a percentage grade). Aggregate score data can help identify colleges and departments effectively addressing digital content accessibility, and areas where additional work is needed. Individual instructors may also wish to understand the types of accessibility issues and should explore course-level reports.

### 2.4.1. Aggregate to Course-level Data

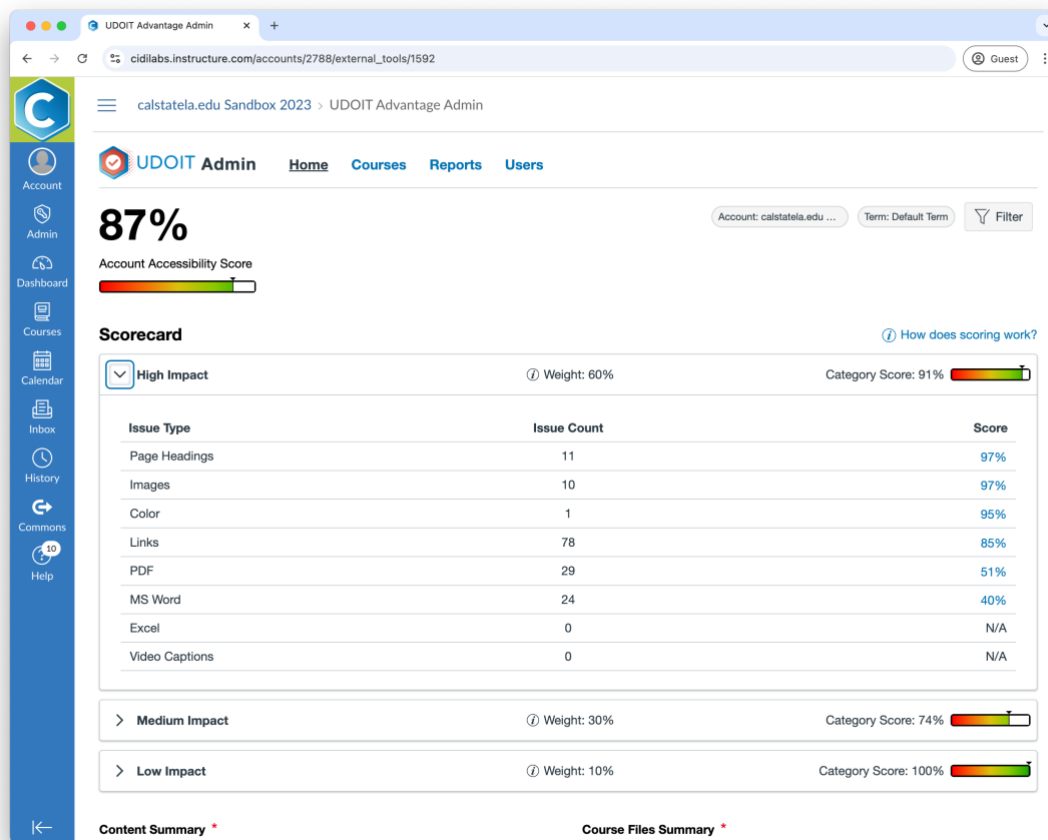
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Both aggregate score data (campus-wide, college, department data) and course-level data communicate important information. Aggregate data helps show accessibility score trends over time and across academic units (e.g., colleges, departments). Course-level data helps identify content heavy courses with numerous accessibility challenges.

Both Ally and UDOIT provide the following types of score data (aggregated and disaggregated):

- Average course accessibility score.
- Total count of content, by type.
- Total count of specific issues.





The Cidi Labs UDOIT account level dashboard displays accessibility scores for all Canvas courses.

## 2.4.2. Gather and Share Accessibility Reporting Data

Access to aggregated accessibility reporting data typically requires administrator access in the LMS. Coordinate with the LMS Administrator to obtain ready-made reports or .csv files of exported data. Ensure the requested reports contain the types of score data needed. Ask that exported data or reports are configured to code data by a specific term or academic year.

Consider the following when gathering and sharing the reporting data:

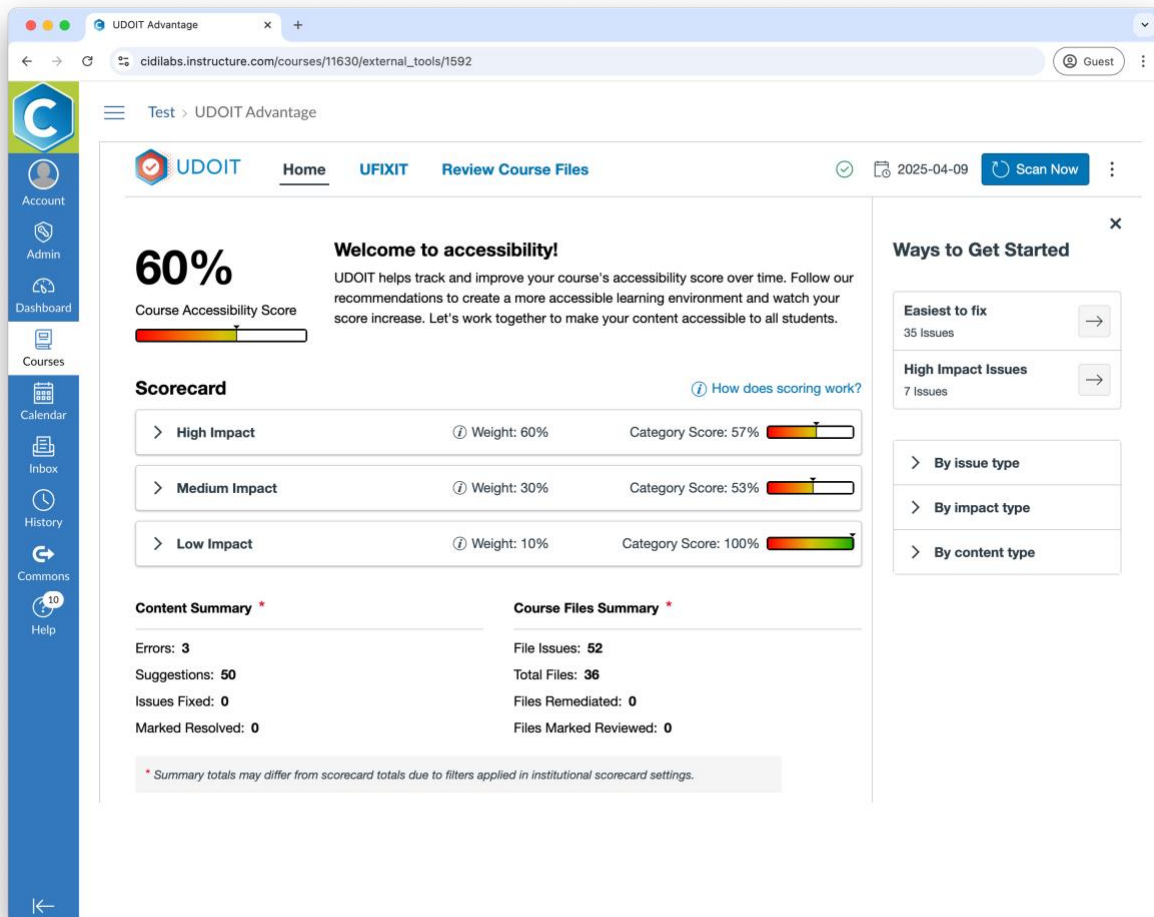
- Create simplified reports showing 1-2 performance metrics (e.g., average score, plus total inaccessible files).
- Exercise caution when sharing reports widely, as they may contain confidential or sensitive data.
- Protect course-level reports, making access only available to individual instructors and senior leadership.
- Create reports tailored to a specific audience, filtering out data unrelated to that audience (e.g., college-level report for all department chairs of the college).
- Consider loading exported data into Tableau or Power BI to allow stakeholders access to the latest reports.

### 2.4.3. Instructor Use of Course-level Reports

Encourage individual instructors to make use of course-level accessibility reports. Both Ally and UDOIT provide a report interface, allowing instructors to see their course accessibility score and the number and types of specific issues.

Consider the following when encouraging instructor use of course-level reports:

- Create easy to find instructor help guides.
- Identify a unit to provide support and training on using the accessibility report.
- Preconfigure the LMS to display the accessibility report option (Canvas Course Menu) so instructors need not activate it manually.



The Cidi Labs UDOIT course-level dashboard displays an accessibility score and offers instructors suggestions to fix content by level of difficulty and by impact.

### Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 2)

- Coordinate messaging campaigns with executive leadership.
- Build awareness among faculty and identify/manage points of engagement.
- Coordinate and manage campus-wide communications.
- Schedule and host faculty Q&A sessions and accessibility office hours.
- Enable faculty-to-faculty outreach via accessibility champions.



- Use data to illustrate the need for digital accessibility remediation.

### 3. Developing Capacity for Remediation Workflows

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Developing capacity for remediation workflows is a foundational step in meeting digital accessibility goals and ensuring sustained progress over time. As campuses face increasing demand to remediate existing content while also ensuring future materials are accessible from the start, it becomes essential to build the infrastructure, staffing, and processes needed to support this work at scale. Capacity-building involves more than hiring or assigning personnel; it includes developing efficient workflows, investing in tools and training, clarifying roles and responsibilities, and fostering cross-functional collaboration. Without these elements in place, remediation efforts risk becoming inconsistent, reactive, and unsustainable.

#### 3.1. Student Labor as a Remediation Force

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Leveraging student assistants provides a cost-effective and scalable approach to increasing capacity for digital content remediation. By strategically utilizing student workers, including those with work-study awards, campuses can expand their workforce while ensuring sustainable workflows. While student assistants play a significant role, it is essential that full-time staff members remain actively involved to guide complex cases and maintain quality control.

##### 3.1.1 Recruitment and Hiring Student Technology Assistants

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###### **Recruitment and Onboarding:**

Departments should actively recruit student assistants to support digital content remediation. Work-study students offer a distinct advantage in expanding the workforce, as their wages are partially funded through financial aid programs. However, work-study awards may change, so it is advisable to hire a larger pool of students and train them in advance to ensure workforce continuity.

###### **Best Practices for Work-Study and Non-Work-Study Hiring:**

- Prioritize work-study students to maximize institutional funding but maintain a budget for additional student employees who may not qualify for work-study.
- Over-hire and pre-train a broader group of students so that additional workers are available if work-study hours fluctuate.
- Ensure a structured hiring and onboarding process that includes accessibility awareness training.
- Build a relationship with a member of your financial aid team that can assist you with navigating financial aid awards.
  - TIP: verse yourself on how work study applies to summer months.
- Understand your division and department work study allocations.
  - This will require relationships with your division budget staff and/or administration.



- Example Job descriptions can be found in the assets folder.

### 3.1.2 Process for Training Student Technology Assistants

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Training student assistants requires a phased approach, beginning with a small core group of well-trained students who can later mentor others in a trickle-down training model. A dedicated staff member should focus on training an initial cohort of three to four student assistants to build a strong foundation before expanding the team.

#### Training Modules:

- **PDF Remediation:** Students must be proficient in Adobe Acrobat for document tagging, reading order adjustments, and alternative text descriptions. Though the CSU system provides access to Equidox, students should also learn Acrobat-based remediation to ensure continuity if Equidox is unavailable.
- **Microsoft Office Remediation:** Students should complete WebAIM training on accessibility best practices for Word and PowerPoint. Compared to PDFs, Microsoft Office remediation requires a lighter training lift but remains essential.
- **Captioning Remediation:** Vendor-based captioning tools often include instructional resources. Student assistants should familiarize themselves with the specific processes required for the captioning tools used by their campus.

#### Scalability and Quality Assurance:

- **Student Lead Model:** Once the initial group of trained students gains expertise, they transition into student lead roles to train new assistants, creating a scalable and sustainable workflow.
- **Complex File Escalation:** Staff members remain available to handle highly complex files and ensure quality assurance.
- **Crosscheck Certification:** To ensure accuracy, student assistants should have their early remediation work reviewed by peers or supervisors before final implementation.

### 3.1.3 Systemwide Equidox Licenses

---

The CSU system maintains a 72-concurrent user license for Equidox, providing an average of three licenses per campus. Since Equidox allows for more assigned users than concurrent logins, campuses can structure access to accommodate remediation teams of varying sizes. Campuses requiring additional licenses can negotiate for expanded access as needed.

## 3.2 Calculating Throughput

---

Estimating throughput for digital content remediation is inherently complex due to the number of fluctuating variables that impact file processing times. In the Chico State example below, they have refined their approach over nearly a decade of implementing student assistant-based remediation. While the process remains nuanced, they offer the following assumptions and methodology to help anchor planning and resource allocation.



## Key Factors That Influence Throughput

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- **Student Assistant Training Levels** – The proficiency of student assistants has a direct impact on speed and accuracy. Our assumptions are based on well-trained students.
- **File Length and Complexity** – Simpler documents (e.g., short Word or PDF files) are completed significantly faster than complex ones (e.g., long scientific articles with charts, data tables, or scanned text).
- **Human and System Variables** – Illness, academic workload, schedule availability, and occasional system downtimes can all affect productivity.

## Chico State Student Assistant Capacity

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- **Team Size:** 17 student assistants
- **Average Weekly Hours per Student:** 11 hours
- **Assumed Training Level:** High (well-trained and experienced)

## Throughput Estimates

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### Easy Files

- **Definition:** Shorter, well-structured documents with minimal accessibility barriers.
- **Estimated Completion Time:** 0–3 hours
- **Average Assumption:** 1 hour per file
- **Top Performers:** Completing easy files in approximately 30 minutes
- **Per-Student Weekly Output (Average):** 12–15 files
- **Per-Student Weekly Output (Top Performer):** Up to 20 files

### Difficult Files

- **Definition:** Longer documents or those with complex formatting (e.g., scanned PDFs, detailed tables, or embedded multimedia).
- **Estimated Completion Time:** 3–5 hours
- **Average Assumption:** 4 hours per file
- **Per-Student Weekly Output:** 4–5 files

## Weekly Throughput Projection

---

Assuming a strategic distribution of labor:

- **12 students assigned to easy files**  
→ 12 students × ~20 files/week = **240 easy files per week**
- **5 students assigned to difficult files**  
→ 5 students × ~5 files/week = **25 difficult files per week**

**Total Estimated Weekly Output:**  
**~265 remediated files per week**



## Monthly Projection (4 Weeks)

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- **Easy Files:**  $240/\text{week} \times 4 = 960$  easy files/month
- **Difficult Files:**  $25/\text{week} \times 4 = 100$  difficult files/month
- **Total Estimated Monthly Output:** ~1,060 remediated files

**Note:** Chico State has been within 20% of their estimated throughput consistently over several years except for a 9-month period during a staffing transition.

## 3.3 Leveraging Vendors for Scalable Remediation and Workflow Continuity

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Using vendor partners for digital content remediation effectively ensures your workflow remains scalable and adaptable to fluctuating capacity and complexity. By leveraging their expertise, you can handle high-volume remediation demands without overloading internal resources while also addressing complex accessibility issues that require specialized knowledge. Vendor remediation costs are associated, so budgeting for this eventuality should be considered when determining overall costs, such as hiring student assistants.

Below are some examples of when having a built-in outsourcing technique in your remediation workflow will ensure that the service continues to meet unforeseen demands:

- The document's complexity—whether due to content or size—makes remediation impractical.
- The workflow is at full capacity, causing significant delays for additional remediation tasks.
- Staffing shortages risk disrupting the continuity of your remediation workflow.

## Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 3)

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- Recruit and train student assistants or interns in accessibility remediation.
- Establish clear task roles for staff, student workers, and vendors.
- Implement quality assurance protocols, including review and feedback cycles.
- Ensure all student workers have access to tools such as Equidox and Adobe Acrobat.
- Build contingency plans for scaling capacity using vendor services when needed.

## 4. Whole Course Remediation Workflow and Process

---

An efficient and scalable remediation workflow is critical for working towards and maintaining accessible digital content within the Canvas LMS. This section provides campuses with a structured framework to set up and manage a process to remediate entire Canvas courses. This remediation process requires less involvement from instructors, who simply agree to have instructional material contained within the course made accessible. This process ideally occurs well before the start of the academic term in which the materials are needed.

By following this workflow, campuses can establish a transparent, repeatable, and scalable remediation process that improves efficiency, enhances accessibility compliance, and ensures consistency across courses and departments. This framework is designed to support campuses at various stages of their accessibility initiatives, whether they are just beginning to implement remediation or refining an existing process.



## 4.1. Service Request Form and Process Initiation

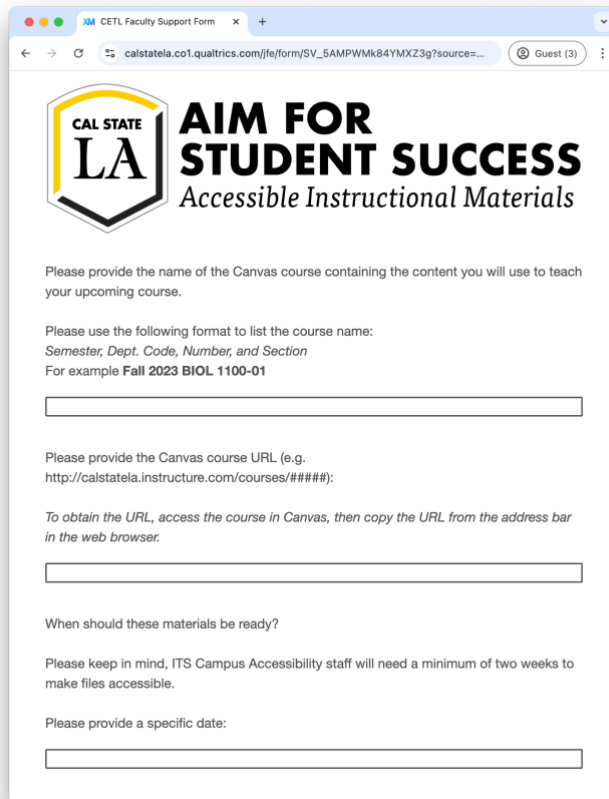
The campus should create an instructor request form. The form is sent or made available to instructors. Submitting the form initiates the remediation process. The collected information is then routed to the correct campus team members for processing. A request process also ensures instructors identify the correct and most up to date version of their course.

### 4.1.1 Create Request Form to Collect Information

Instructors requesting remediation services must identify a specific Canvas course for remediation. Create a form to collect the class name and course URL. Collect instructor contact information in case questions arise during remediation.

Consider the following when creating the request form:

- Decide between using a survey platform or an existing IT ticketing system to create an online request form. A survey platform may offer greater flexibility in creating the form. An existing ticketing system may offer more seamless integration with existing workflows.
- Decide whether to collect additional demographic data such as department, college, and position (department chair, course coordinator, tenure-track faculty, lecturer).
- To ensure the course is returned in time before the start of term, consider asking for a desired completion date for course remediation.
- To help prioritize remediation, collect details on the type of course (multi-section, large lecture, blueprint course, or fully online course).
- Consider deactivating the request form when insufficient time remains to remediate before the start of the term (instead point instructors to on-demand remediation).



The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL [calstatela.co1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV\\_5AMPWMk84YMXZ3g?source=...](http://calstatela.co1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_5AMPWMk84YMXZ3g?source=...). The form is titled "AIM FOR STUDENT SUCCESS" with the subtitle "Accessible Instructional Materials" and the Cal State LA logo. It contains the following sections:

- Course Name:** "Please provide the name of the Canvas course containing the content you will use to teach your upcoming course." It includes a format example: "Semester, Dept. Code, Number, and Section" and "For example Fall 2023 BIOL 1100-01". There is a text input field below.
- Course URL:** "Please provide the Canvas course URL (e.g. <http://calstatela.instructure.com/courses/#####>):" It includes instructions: "To obtain the URL, access the course in Canvas, then copy the URL from the address bar in the web browser." There is a text input field below.
- Completion Date:** "When should these materials be ready?" It includes a note: "Please keep in mind, ITS Campus Accessibility staff will need a minimum of two weeks to make files accessible." and "Please provide a specific date:". There is a text input field below.

**A request form in Qualtrics collects basic information from instructors seeking digital accessibility support.**

#### **4.1.2 Distribute Request Form to Instructors**

---

Send the request form directly to instructors. Using the course prioritization criteria identified in Section 1.5 Prioritization of Courses & Instructional Materials Remediation, gather the course names and instructor contact information of the priority courses. Work with academic leadership (e.g., college deans and department chairs) to identify courses with the greatest need in terms of enrollment size and course impact. Work with disability services and student support offices to identify courses where students are requesting accessible instructional materials.

Consider the following when distributing the request form:

- Send the request form to batches of instructors as course names and instructor contact information becomes available.
- Determine an appropriate cadence for instructor reminders to complete the form.
- If using a survey platform for the request form, use the built-in messaging tools to send automated and targeted reminders to instructors teaching priority courses.
- Students may need to register for courses in the upcoming term before prioritization occurs.
- The campus disability services office may already notify instructors when a student requests an accommodation. Determine whether the request form can be included in this notification.
- In messaging that accompanies the request form, include the course name and term to ensure instructors submit the correct course for remediation. Choose a survey platform (Qualtrics) with text piping or use mail merge in Microsoft Office.

#### **4.1.3 Monitor Request Form Responses**

---

To monitor the effectiveness of the outreach and awareness campaign, track the numbers of requests received. Executive stakeholders and/or academic leadership may wish to monitor response rates by instructors teaching priority courses.

Consider the following when monitoring the request form submissions:

- Track the request form response rate by dividing total responses received by total instructors contacted.
- Monitor the colleges, departments, or groups of instructors not taking advantage of the remediation service. Reach out to the leaders of those specific colleges and departments for support with outreach to instructors.

### **4.2. Remediation Workflow Task Management**

---

The campus should use a task management system to receive, assign, and monitor remediation service requests. A new or existing system should capture and display the state of each step in the remediation workflow. Kanban-style tracking systems such as Trello, MeisterTask, Notion or more traditional IT ticketing systems like Jira or ServiceNow provide a structured way to monitor and manage remediation tasks from assignment to completion.



### 4.2.1 Access to Task Management Systems

---

Members of the remediation team should have access to the systems used to track and management the remediation workflow. Ensure the campus allots enough seats in the various systems used. Confirm with central IT if student assistants are permitted to access the IT ticketing system.

Consider the following when arranging access:

- Confirm with vendors the ability to provision or de-provision access to systems. This conserves account licenses for current remediation team members and keeps systems secure.

### 4.2.2 Ingest or Route Service Requests for Staging

---

If using a survey platform, the task management system should ingest service requests it receives from the online form. Configure an automated email to send details from the online form to the task management system. The email should include information for the course requiring remediation (class name, course URL, instructor contact information).

If the service request form exists in the IT ticketing system, alert frontline IT staff to expect remediation requests. Provide guidance for routing requests to the remediation team.

Consider the following when ingesting or routing requests:

- If using a survey platform, use text piping to include class name, course URL, instructor contact information in the email sent to the task management system.
- If using an existing ticketing system, ask IT to create an assignment group for remediation requests.
- When adopting new task management tools, look for systems that include an online form option.

### 4.2.3 Establish Workflow Stages

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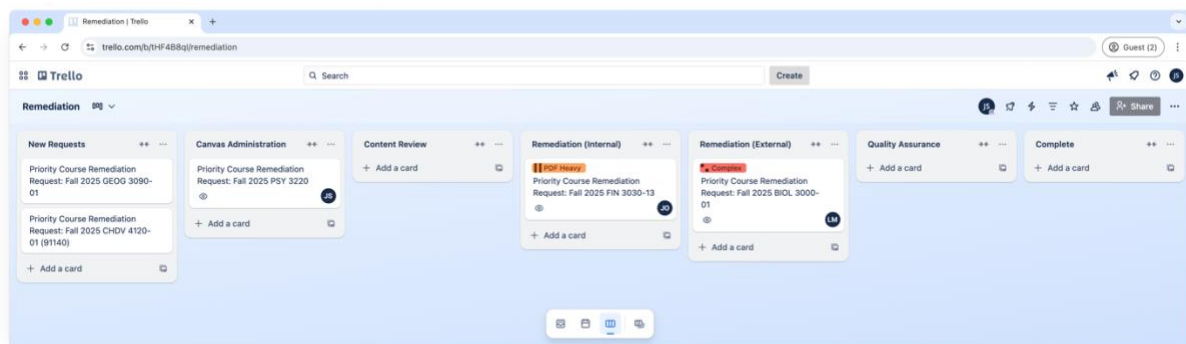
Configure the task management system to track the progression of new requests through the stages of the remediation workflow. Workflow stages may reflect the routing of the remediation request to different groups or an individual that performs a series of tasks. Stages may also reflect each task within the workflow (regardless of group/individual performing the work). Workflows may also have some combination of both approaches.

#### Example Workflow Stages

| One Stage for Multiple Tasks (Fewer/Simpler)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Combination                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | One Stage for One Task (Complex)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>A group or individual performs multiple tasks at each stage:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• New Request</li> <li>• Canvas Administration</li> <li>• Content Review</li> <li>• Remediation (Internal)</li> <li>• Remediation (External)</li> <li>• Quality Assurance</li> <li>• Complete</li> </ul> | <p>A group or individual performs one task only or multiple tasks at each stage:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• New Request</li> <li>• Canvas Administration</li> <li>• Remove Duplicate Files</li> <li>• Inventory Course Content</li> <li>• Internal Remediation</li> <li>• Send to External Vendor</li> <li>• Quality Assurance</li> <li>• Complete</li> </ul> | <p>A group or individual performs a single task at each stage:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• New Request</li> <li>• Review Request</li> <li>• Copy Canvas Course</li> <li>• Add Remediation Team</li> <li>• Capture Accessibility Score Data</li> <li>• Remove Duplicate Files</li> <li>• Inventory Course Content</li> <li>• Internal Remediation</li> <li>• Send to External Vendor</li> <li>• Quality Assurance</li> <li>• Remediation Complete</li> <li>• Notify Faculty</li> </ul> |

Consider the following when establishing workflow stages:

- Balance simplicity with the need for detail. Fewer stages may hide the true complexity of the workflow.
- The one stage for one task approach may result in an abundance of automatic notifications to remediation team members.
- Consolidate tasks that can only be performed by a single individual into a single workflow stage.



Tools like Trello offer a kanban board to monitor the stages of the remediation workflow.

## 4.2.4 Progression and Task Assignment

When a request progresses to the next workflow stage, determine how to assign the tasks associated with that stage. For tasks in the workflow performed by a single individual, configure automatic assignment. When multiple team members can perform the work, manually assign the tasks to balance workload and leverage the skill of more experienced team members.

### Example Task Assignments



| Automatic Task Assignment                                                                                                                                                                           | Manual Task Assignment                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>A new request is manually moved to the Canvas Administration stage. Tasks associated with this stage are automatically assigned to the LMS Admin.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Fulltime remediation team member manually assigns a complex remediation request to a more experienced student assistant.</li> </ul> |

### 4.3. Canvas Course Preparation

---

The campus should coordinate with the LMS Administrator for assistance in preparing Canvas courses for remediation. The LMS Administrator or their designee should create a duplicate course and provide the remediation team access to the copy. The remediation team should capture essential accessibility score data, address duplicate files, and then begin remediation work.

#### 4.3.1 Course Duplication in Canvas for Accessibility Work

---

The LMS Administrator or their designee should first duplicate the course undergoing remediation. The remediation team can work without disrupting a live course or concluded course from a past semester. In a course copy, the instructor is less likely to upload additional material (accidently interfering with the remediation).

Consider the following when creating a course copy:

- Decide whether the instructor should retain access to the copy of their course during remediation.
- Follow a consistent course naming convention so instructors can later distinguish between remediated and non-remediated copies of their courses.
- Consider placing course copies in a separate Canvas sub-account to maintain an accurate count of remediated courses.

#### 4.3.2 Remediation Team Canvas Access

---

The LMS Administrator or their designee should provide an appropriate remediation team member access to the duplicate course. Avoid adding the entire remediation team (all student assistants) to every course. Course access should be on an as-needed basis (access to assigned courses only). The appropriate remediation team member can add a student worker to their assigned course.

Consider the following when providing access to duplicate courses:

- Remediation team members added to courses should have access to download and upload files and edit modules, pages, and activities and assignments. Consider the Designer role in Canvas when adding users to the course.
- By placing course copies in a separate Canvas sub-account, the appropriate remediation team member could have sub-account administrator access (access to every course within the sub-account).
- Implement a procedure to ensure student assistants do not have access to course files in courses they are taking.

### 4.3.3 Capture Accessibility Score Data

---

The LMS Administrator, their designee, or the remediation team should capture pre-remediation accessibility data. This may include the overall accessibility score or total number of inaccessible files.

Consider the following when capturing data:

- Capture data related to one or more key performance indicators identified in this framework.
- Balance the need for capturing data against the time spent collecting the data. Teams should prioritize remediation.
- Determine whether the data needed is already captured elsewhere (campus-level accessibility score report, or within the original Canvas course).

### 4.3.4 Duplicate File Clean Up

---

The LMS Administrator, their designee, or the remediation team should run a TidyUP file scan before beginning individual document remediation. TidyUP helps ensure only files currently in use are remediated. Before deleting duplicate or unused files, create an archive of all files contained within the course. Although remediation work occurs in a course copy, an easily accessed archive can help restore a deleted or corrupted file without needing to access the original course.

Consider the following when using TidyUP:

- Determine where to store the file archive. If storing within the course itself, create a zip archive (to prevent rescanning by accessibility tools).
- If storing archived files outside the LMS, choose a university approved file management tool such as OneDrive or Google Drive. Ensure the instructor can access their archived materials.

## 4.4 Remediation Tasks

---

The remediation team should begin processing content within the duplicate course. The team should focus on technically complex fixes that are too difficult for instructors to address (e.g., tagging PDFs, captioning video). Instructors should address easier fixes within their courses, such as heading styles, alt-text, descriptive hyperlinks, and color contrast (Canvas Rich Content Editor accessibility).

### 4.4.1 Review of Course Content and Escalation of Complex Files

---

An experienced remediation team member (fulltime employee) should review course content to assess the amount and types of content. STEM courses may feature complex diagrams or equations where familiarity with subject matter is needed. Content that exceeds student assistant capabilities (e.g., detailed forms, scientific documents with complex images, etc.) may be forwarded to an external vendor. Exercise caution when providing student assistants access to courses they are currently taking or will take in the future.

Consider the following when reviewing course content:

- Identify specific remediation team members with prior knowledge and experience in STEM topics.
- Determine how best to use external vendors to process complex diagrams or equations.

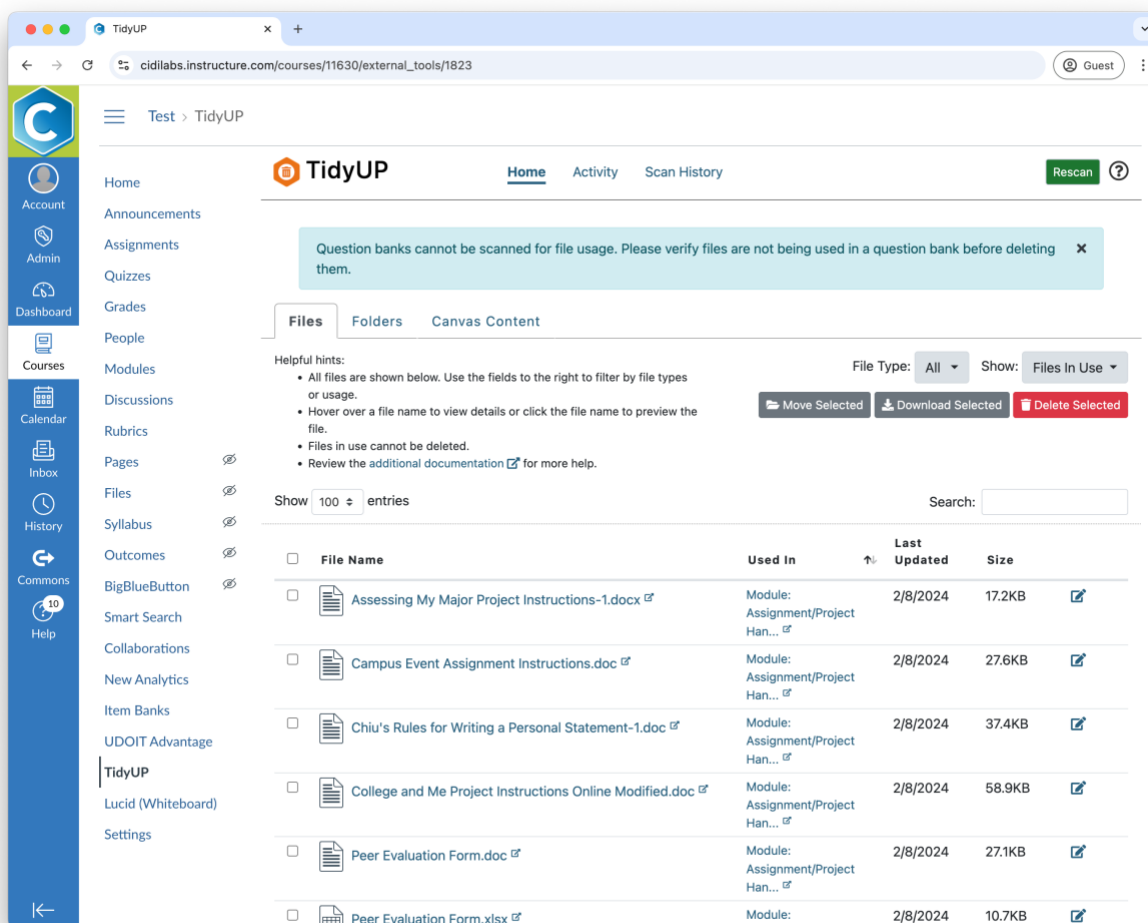
### 4.4.2 Digital File Remediation

---

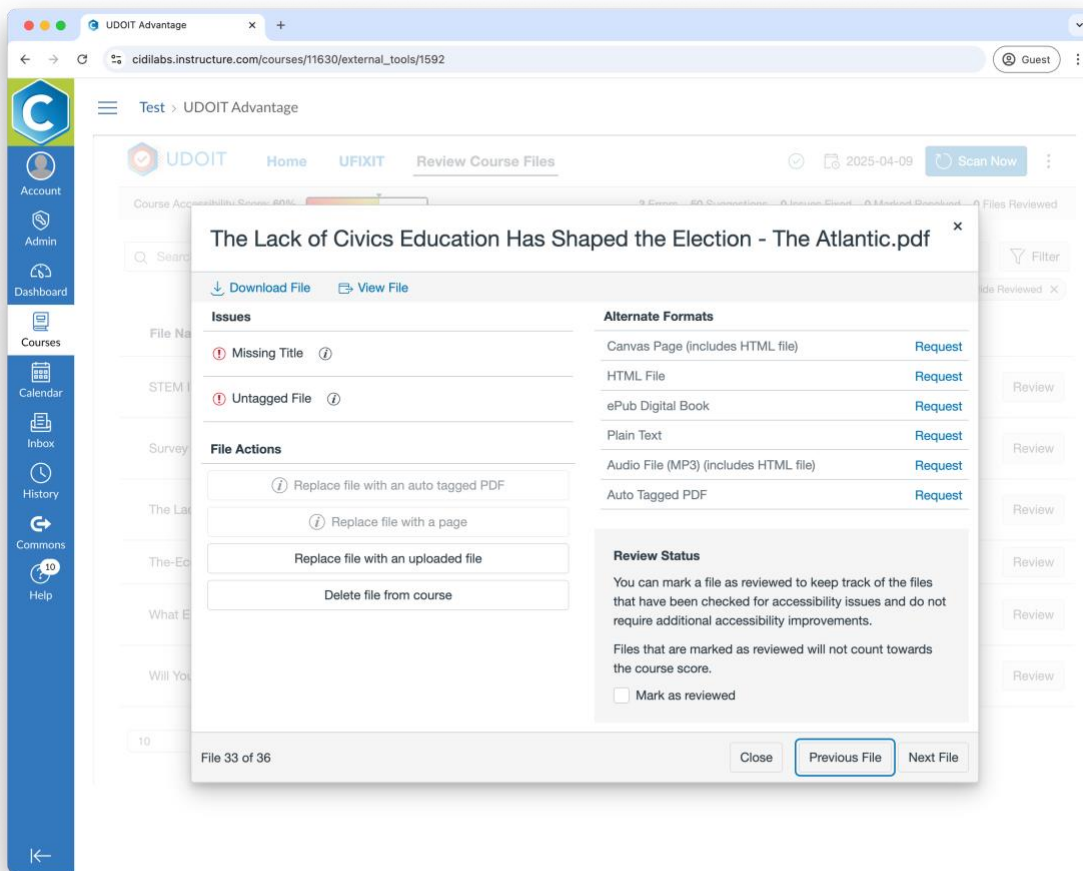
Remediation team members should identify inaccessible files, download them, and make them accessible. Tools to support this work may include Cidi Labs UDOIT and TidyUP, as well as Equidox.

Consider the following when remediating digital files:

- TidyUP provides a function to batch download all files from a Canvas course. This is likely easier than locating files throughout various modules and pages. However, TidyUP does not indicate accessibility issues.
- Cidi Labs UDOIT provides a “Review Course Files” interface, indicating current accessibility issues. The interface provides an option to download a single file and/or replace with a remediated version. A batch download option is not available.
- Files remediated through Equidox (or similar tool) can be uploaded using the UDOIT “Replace file with an uploaded file” option.



**Cidi Labs TidyUP may reduce remediation turnaround times by helping to eliminate duplicate files.**



The Cidi Labs UDOIT interface offers a course files specific view to help download and then replace inaccessible files.

#### 4.4.3 Video Captions and Audio Descriptions

Remediation team members should identify media requiring captions and/or audio descriptions. Leverage professional vendor services where possible to ensure media is compliant. This may include Verbit and Echo Labs.

Consider the following when remediating media:

- Identify features within LMS accessibility scanning tools to identify media.
- Determine whether a streaming media platform is available on campus and whether an integration exists for accessible media vendor services (e.g., Verbit integration in Panopto).
- Assess the feasibility of moving media to the centralized media platforms for remediation (e.g., Zoom recordings, instructor content in Youtube, or embedded Canvas media).

#### 4.4.4 File and Media Management

Team members may include specialists who perform a single remediation task or generalists who perform a variety of tasks. File and media management may be required to organize content by type into batches for processing by a specialist. For instance, a team member who specializes in PDF accessibility may process all PDFs across multiple courses. Or a team member is capable of remediating PDFs and video captioning.

Consider the following when managing course content:

- Determine the most efficient method for providing access to content, either direct access to the course, or from access to a folder containing content from the course.
- Choose a university approved file management tool such as SharePoint or Google Drive to store batches of content for processing.
- Consider methods for returning remediated files and media to the correct course (e.g., keywords in metadata, folder names corresponding to course names).

## 4.5 Returning Accessible Courses to Instructors

With remediation work complete, return accessible course copies to instructors. Provide information on the services performed and how best to maintain the accessibility of their instructional materials.

### 4.5.1 Restore Instructor Course Access

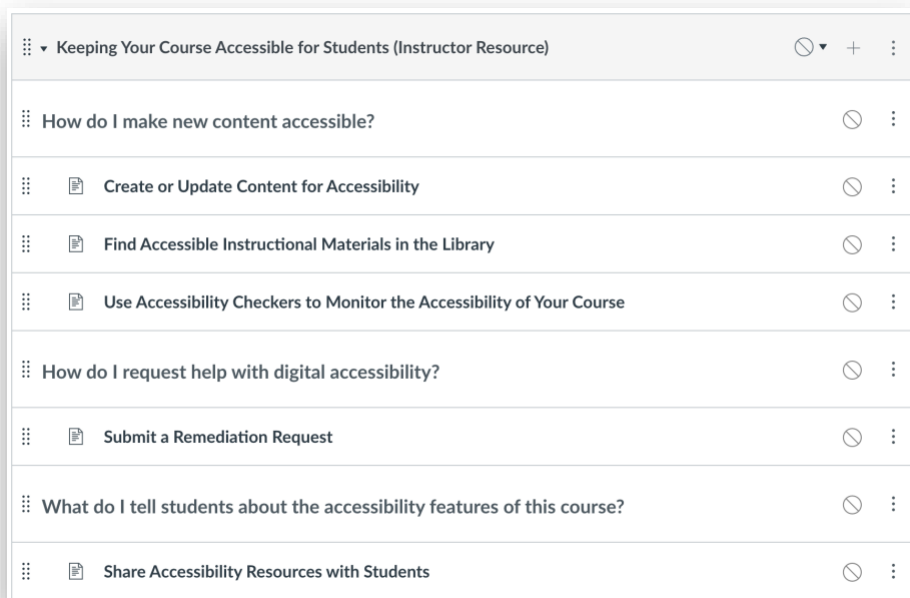
The LMS Administrator, their designee, or members of the remediation team should restore instructor access to the course copy.

### 4.5.2 Contact Instructors

Message the instructor once their course is ready and available to access. Messaging should provide instructions for how to use the remediated course copy, including how to import the course content into the live course section for teaching.

Consider the following when contacting instructors:

- Where possible, detail the types of remediation work completed.
- Explain any accessibility fixes the instructor must still address.
- Add an unpublished module to the course containing instructor resources for maintaining the materials and links to other services available (on-demand remediation).



**A module inserted into the remediated Canvas course provides instructors resources for maintaining the accessibility of their course materials.**

## Implementation Checklist (KPI's Section 4)

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- Establish an online form for remediation services and monitor requests.
- Set up workflows to manage remediation work.
- Partner with Canvas LMS Administrator for Canvas course prep.
- Identify specific remediation tasks to perform.
- Establish an orderly process of returning remediated courses to faculty.

## 5. On-Demand Remediation

---

In addition to whole-course accessibility efforts, campuses must be prepared to address urgent or ad-hoc accessibility needs. The on-demand file remediation process ensures that instructors can request immediate remediation for individual files needed for coursework. This approach is especially critical when a student with a disability requires an accessible version of course materials on short notice or when an instructor prepares a course for the first time and discovers inaccessible content. This process can also be leveraged for administrative documents by staff who need to request remediated documents before publication or distribution.

This section provides campuses with a structured workflow for managing on-demand requests, including a faculty submission process, defined turnaround times, and an escalation protocol for complex files that require additional expertise. By establishing a streamlined request and response system, campuses can build trust and support from faculty and meet accessibility requirements without delaying instruction. Non-academic staff will likely use this on-demand process. Assess the types of content non-academic staff are likely to submit for processing (e.g., flyers, handouts, handbooks, student guides).

### 5.1. Request Form and File Submission Process

---

Unlike whole-course remediation, the on-demand process should allow users to upload files directly to the request form. Create a dedicated on-demand request form or create a branch within the existing form for on-demand requests. Collect user contact information and the date when the accessible files are needed. Determine a reasonable turnaround time for urgent requests.

Consider the following when creating the request form:

- To ensure efficient processing, users submitting a request should be prompted to identify file types, specific accessibility issues, and level of urgency.
- Set or recommend a maximum number of files per request.
- Identify a means for returning large files to users (where email attachment size is an issue).
- Decide between using a survey platform or an existing IT ticketing system to create an online request form. Consider the system used for the whole-course remediation request form, and whether they should be the same.
- Decide whether to collect additional demographic data such as department, college/division, and position (faculty, staff, administrator).



**Document Remediation Request**

This form is to be used by faculty and staff to request an accessible version of your document. Remediated materials are returned via OneDrive or Canvas. Complex documents will take longer to remediate. If you have any questions or need assistance completing this form, please email [accessibility@calstatela.edu](mailto:accessibility@calstatela.edu).

Opened by  
Jeffrey Suarez-Grant (jsuare23)

**REQUESTOR INFORMATION**

\* Requested for

**DOCUMENT INFORMATION**

\* Are you the document author?  
Please select

\* Is this document for a student accommodation (OSD student is enrolled in my class)?  
Please select

\* How many pages is this document?  
Please select

\* Is it crucial that you receive the accessible file in the same file format?  
Please select

\* Do you need rush service? (Minimum 2 business day turnaround)  
Please select

\* Due date (minimum turnaround is 5 business days)  
Please select

Upload the document  
Click on the Paper Clip to attach document.

**Submit Request**

A request form in ServiceNow enables faculty and staff to submit small batches of files for remediation.

## 5.2 Task Management for One-Demand Workflow

On-demand remediation tasks are likely similar to whole-course remediation work. The campus should determine whether to use the same task management system for both workflows. On-demand requests may flow directly into a remediation workflow stage (bypassing earlier Canvas course prep stages).

## 5.3. Task Assignment for Urgent Requests

The remediation team should monitor and identify urgent requests. A full-time team member should assign urgent requests to more experienced student assistants. Urgent requests should be fulfilled within a defined turnaround time (e.g., 24-48 hours).

## 5.4. Review of Content and Escalation of Complex Files

As with the whole-course remediation workflow, an experienced remediation team member (full-time employee) should review files to assess the amount and type of content. Files that exceed student



assistant capabilities (e.g., detailed forms, scientific documents with complex images, etc.) may be forwarded to an external vendor. The remediation team may need to break up large batches of files submitted via a single request form and adjust the turnaround time.

### **Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 5)**

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- Create an online form for faculty and staff to submit individual file requests.
- Define turnaround time targets and escalation protocols for urgent requests.
- Triage incoming files and route them to appropriate staff, student, or vendor.
- Track file type, complexity, and turnaround time for internal metrics.
- Include non-academic content (e.g., flyers, HR docs) in the workflow planning.

## **6. Remediating Web, Mobile App, and Public-Facing Content**

---

Public-facing content, including institutional websites, mobile applications, digital signage, portals, and externally visible platforms, is within the scope of digital accessibility compliance. While much of this framework focuses on instructor content within the LMS, campuses must also establish plans to identify, prioritize, and remediate accessibility barriers across all digital experiences. This work is essential not only to meet ADA Title II requirements but also to ensure equal access for all users, including prospective students, employees, parents, and the public.

### **6.1 Inventory and Scope of Public-Facing Content**

---

Start by conducting a comprehensive inventory of public-facing content, including:

- Main institutional website(s), department/program pages, and campus microsites
- Mobile apps (campus services, learning portals, emergency alert systems, etc.)
- Document repositories and policy libraries
- HR portals and employment application pages
- Admissions, financial aid, and registration areas

Use campus-supported web governance or accessibility auditing tools (e.g., Siteimprove, Monsido, DubBot) to:

- Count number of pages, embedded documents, and media files
- Identify recurring accessibility issues and patterns
- Generate reports for visibility and prioritization

Document third-party platforms that fall outside the LMS but still present essential content or services.

### **6.2 Prioritization Framework for Public-Facing Remediation**

---

Use a similar logic as the LMS remediation effort to determine which digital properties to address first. Suggested prioritization factors include:

- Traffic volume: Use web analytics to identify which pages or tools receive the most visits. Pages with high traffic are more likely to impact users and trigger complaints.
- Functional importance: Prioritize areas critical for navigation, enrollment, employment, and essential services (e.g., admissions, job postings, campus housing, registration).





- Risk exposure: Consider platforms where an accessibility barrier could prevent access to legal rights or public information.
- Document complexity: Identify sites with large volumes of PDFs, forms, or multimedia content that require intensive remediation.

## 6.3 Staffing and Workflow Considerations

---

If you have an established student assistant team for LMS remediation, consider assigning a sub-team to focus on public content. This group may:

- Remediate PDFs hosted on public websites
- Replace documents with accessible HTML pages where feasible
- Assist in accessibility testing for mobile apps and public tools

Ensure this team is trained in web-specific remediation standards, including:

- WCAG 2.1 AA success criteria
- ARIA roles and landmarks
- Color contrast and keyboard navigation
- Accessible media and document publishing

## 6.4 Roadmap Development and Compliance Alignment

---

Create a written roadmap outlining:

- Which public-facing systems or sections will be reviewed each term
- How remediation work will be sequenced and resourced
- The metrics used to define success (e.g., percentage of top-visited pages compliant)
  - This roadmap is useful in the event of a complaint, showing good faith effort and a systematic approach to compliance. It also helps align accessibility timelines with redesign cycles and staffing availability.

## 6.5 Ongoing Maintenance and Monitoring

---

Make public-facing content remediation an ongoing effort, not a one-time project. Suggestions include:

- Scheduling quarterly scans of high-traffic web domains
- Establishing guidelines for accessible content submission from departments
- Training content contributors and editors
- Assigning campus liaisons to monitor key sites or app performance

### Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 6)

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- Conduct an inventory of all public-facing web/mobile content
- Create a prioritization framework
- Assign and train student/staff teams for this content type
- Develop and document a phased roadmap
- Establish maintenance, monitoring, and training structures



## 7. Optimizing Digital Accessibility

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With remediation workflows established, campuses should explore strategies to further optimize digital accessibility, including maintaining the accessibility of materials, addressing accessibility in course design and curriculum innovation, and sophisticated monitoring for inaccessible content.

### 7.1 Post Remediation Maintenance

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We recognize that remediation requires a significant investment of time and effort, and it is disheartening to see courses that have been carefully remediated for accessibility become inaccessible again when new content is introduced. In this section, we outline a comprehensive proactive strategy aimed at ensuring long-term accessibility. Our approach integrates extensive educational initiatives with a clear delineation of roles to empower teams to manage updates effectively.

#### 7.1.1 Education and Training

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We recommend placing a strong emphasis on educating all stakeholders involved. Provide comprehensive training sessions and resources so that everyone understands accessibility standards, remediation techniques, and the impact of new content updates. This proactive education helps in anticipating challenges before they arise and equips teams with the necessary skills to address them promptly.

- Examples for this area can be found in the assets folder.

#### 7.1.2 Roles and Responsibilities

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A well-defined structure with assigned roles and responsibilities is critical to managing the post remediation process effectively. By clarifying who is responsible for monitoring, updating, and maintaining accessibility, we reduce the risk of future issues as content evolves.

We recognize that each campus may have differences in what they will be asking their faculty and staff to be responsible for as part of the proactive strategy. What is most important is that you are clear on the responsibilities. Below is an example of roles and responsibilities:

Faculty and Staff responsibility:

- Add alternative text (alt text) to any images, including images inside of documents
- Add headings to any documents created
- Setting the language
- Any google documents
- Review accessibility level before publishing a document for use in a course
- Submit documents and videos to the central remediation team that need further assistance
- Attend at least one training on digital accessibility

Central Accessibility team:

- Remediation of PDF's and other digital content beyond the scope listed above
- All captioning work



- Just in time training and guidance on a digital accessibility question
- Monitoring of your course(s) for continued accessibility

### 7.1.3 Post Remediation Monitoring and Review

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To maintain the integrity of remediated courses, periodic reviews will need to be conducted. This process will help identify any lapses in accessibility as new content is integrated, allowing for timely corrective measures.

#### Implementation of a Visual Dashboard:

By utilizing a visual dashboard (i.e. PowerBI), you can centralize monitoring efforts. The dashboard is a key instrument for tracking progress and ensuring that remediation efforts yield long-term benefits.

Specifically, these dashboards will monitor new content uploads into courses, and their level of accessibility compliance.

This tracking serves two purposes:

- It allows you to identify when new content is uploaded.
- It enables you to take proactive steps in response.

If uploaded content is faculty's responsibility—such as alt text, headings, or language settings—the central accessibility team will follow up to re-educate faculty on how to correct the content. You can expect that this re-education will be needed a few times before faculty and staff develop the habit of addressing accessibility needs before uploading content.

For content that requires additional remediation support, beyond what faculty and staff scope, a ticket will be opened, and the student assistants or staff responsible for remediation will handle the task. Once the remediation is complete, they will work with the faculty or staff member to ensure they understand the process.

## 7.2 Course Design and Curriculum Innovation

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In collaboration with academic affairs embed digital accessibility into course design and curriculum redesign efforts. The campus is likely redesigning commonly taught GE or multi-section courses for improved student success. Ensure redesigned courses (model or blueprint courses) receive digital accessibility support. Approach distance learning units assisting faculty in designing and developing fully online courses to ensure materials are accessible.

#### Implementation Checklist (KPI's for Section 7)

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- Implement dashboards and reports to track remediation progress and trends.
- Report regularly to leadership on key metrics (courses/files remediated, requests handled).
- Use analytics to identify workflow bottlenecks or departments needing support.
- Facilitate cross-training to expand team capacity and prevent bottlenecks.
- Document and share wins and milestones to promote long-term accountability.

## 8. Recommended Tools & Services (LEON)

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To support effective document remediation, the following tools and services are recommended. These solutions facilitate accessible PDF creation, testing, and reporting, ensuring compliance with WCAG and Section 508 standards. As a system, campuses have access to the following tools and services.

Information and additional resources for all the following tools and services can be found within the ATI Remediation Hub Canvas course. Tonia, could you link to the course here?

## Adobe Acrobat Pro & Student Assistant Training Videos

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Recommended Use: Final remediation and validation of complex or highly formatted documents.

Use the CO ATI video series to train student assistants and accelerate onboarding.

- Intro to PDF Accessibility in Acrobat Pro
  - Covers tags panel, reading order, and accessibility basics.
    - Duration: ~15 minutes
    - Ideal first step for new assistants.
- How to Use the Acrobat Accessibility Checker
  - Walkthrough of built-in checker and interpretation of results.
    - Duration: ~10 minutes
- Tagging Content Correctly
  - Focuses on headings, lists, tables, and alternative text.
    - Duration: ~20 minutes
    - Includes common errors and how to fix them.
- Remediating Scanned Documents
  - When to use OCR, and how to clean up content post-conversion.
    - Duration: ~15 minutes
- Final Review and PAC Testing
  - Demonstrates how to use PAC 2021 after Acrobat remediation.
    - Duration: ~10 minutes
    - Shows how to interpret and respond to PAC results.

## Equidox

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Equidox is a cloud-based PDF remediation tool with an intuitive visual interface.

Recommended Use: High-volume remediation tasks and efficient processing of simple to moderately complex PDFs. Good for non-remediators, easy to learn, and a good entry point to a remediation workflow.

## ABBYY FineReader PDF

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ABBYY FineReader is a powerful OCR and PDF editing tool that supports accessibility by converting scanned or image-based documents into machine-readable and taggable PDFs. Key features include:

- Accurate OCR for converting print or scanned content.
- Export options to accessible PDF, Word, and other formats.



- Supports pre-tagging for easier remediation in Adobe Acrobat or Equidox.

Recommended Use: Converting legacy or scanned documents to accessible formats before detailed tagging.

## PDF Accessibility Checker (PAC 2021)

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PAC is a free Windows-based tool that performs a comprehensive compliance check of tagged PDF documents against the PDF/UA standard. Key features include:

- Detailed accessibility report with a logical structure tree.
- Visual reading order preview.
- Compliance scoring.

Recommended Use: Post-remediation testing and validation of PDF accessibility.

## Allyant (CommonLook)

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Allyant (formerly CommonLook) offers professional remediation services. We are working on a new Master Procurement Agreement with Allyant to provide for discounted outsourced remediation.

Recommended use: To provide scalability to remediation workflows and maintain turnaround times and capacity.

## UDOIT (Universal Design Online Content Inspection Tool)

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UDOIT is an open-source tool that scans Canvas courses for accessibility issues. CSU has negotiated this tool for use within Canvas to provide information on:

- Reports on headings, alt text, contrast, and more.
- Suggested fixes and direct links to edit content.
- Insights for faculty and instructional designers.
- Alternate formats for students

Recommended use: Provide insight into digital content accessibility within the Canvas LMS. Use to prioritize remediation efforts, create a culture of accessibility, and provide data-driven statistics on accessibility and remediation efforts.

## TidyUp

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TidyUp is a document management tool used within Canvas to:

- Audit large volumes of files for accessibility issues.
- Identify redundant or outdated content.
- Help campuses prioritize remediation efforts by file type, age, and usage.



Recommended Use: Triage Canvas content. Eliminate content that is duplicate or archived, and create a remediation backlog based on real data.

## 9. Quick Start Guides

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# Beginner's Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework

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## 1. Conducting a Needs Assessment (Start Here!)

### Inventory Existing Course Content:

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- Use Ally or UDOIT in Canvas to generate course accessibility reports.
- Make a simple list of how many courses use PDFs, Word documents, videos, and PowerPoint slides.

### Identify Key People:

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- Meet with your LMS administrator, disability services office, and instructional design team.
- Start a shared document, team or email thread to keep everyone in the loop on remediation efforts.

### Basic Resource Check:

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- List your available staff, student workers, and any tools already in use (e.g., Equidox, Adobe Acrobat).
- Estimate how many courses or files your current team could handle each semester.

## 2. Building Awareness and Campus Engagement

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### Talk to Faculty:

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- Host a short info session or drop-in Q&A about why accessibility matters and what they can do.
- Make a 1-page handout on what easy fixes they can do.

### Launch a Communication Plan:

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- Ask the Provost or Dean to send a campus-wide announcement.
- Set up a basic webpage with FAQs and a remediation request form. Tips on creating a form are in the remediation framework.

### Start a Champion Network:

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- Ask one or two interested faculty to become accessibility champions.
- Meet with them monthly to gather input and share updates.

## 3. Start Small with Capacity Building

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### Hire or Assign Student Workers:

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- Post a part-time job description for student accessibility assistants.
- Start with 2-3 students and train them using Equidox or WebAIM resources.

### Use What You Have:

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- Don't wait for perfect tools. A Google Sheet to track file status and deadlines works fine to start.



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**Plan for Growth:**

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- As you train students, assign one to become a lead who can train others later.

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**4. Run Your First Whole-Course Remediation**

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**Send a Simple Request Form:**

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- Use Google Forms or Qualtrics or Ticket system to let instructors request help.
- Ask for course name, link, and due date.

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**Create a Course Copy in Canvas:**

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- Work with the LMS admin to duplicate the course.
- Only allow student workers access to the copied version.

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**Fix the Most Common Issues First:**

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- Use TidyUP to remove duplicate/unused files.
- Focus on adding alt text, fixing headings, and replacing inaccessible PDFs.

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**Return the Course:**

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- Email the instructor when the work is done.
- Include a list of what was fixed and what they can do to help maintain accessibility.

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**5. Offer On-Demand Support**

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**Create a Quick Upload Form:**

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- Let faculty upload 1-5 files for fast remediation.
- Create a commitment on turnaround time for basic fixes.

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**Prioritize Urgent Needs:**

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- Track requests in a shared sheet.
- Triage complex items to vendors or trained staff.

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**6. Proactively Maintain Accessibility**

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**Teach the Basics:**

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- Host monthly "Accessibility Office Hours."
- Share 1-pagers like "How to Add Headings in Word."

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**Clarify Roles (example):**

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- Faculty fix basic items (alt text, headings).
- Your team handles complex fixes (PDFs, captions).





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**Keep an Eye on Changes:**

- Use Ally, PowerBI or UDOIT to scan for new issues in courses each term.
- Follow up with helpful, friendly tips.

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## 7. Track What You're Doing

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**Keep It Simple:**

- Use a spreadsheet to track:
- Number of courses remediated
- Files fixed
- Student hours used

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**Share Successes:**

- Report numbers to leadership every semester.
- Highlight a faculty success story in newsletters.

This beginner's guide will help you make steady progress without being overwhelmed. Start small, build your team, and celebrate early wins. Accessibility is a journey, and your leadership is key to making it happen.

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## Intermediate Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework

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This guide is designed for individuals who are past the beginner phase but not yet operating at the campus-wide strategy or automation level. You may be coordinating multi-course remediation, leading a team of student workers, managing forms and workflows, or supporting faculty engagement. This guide will help you formalize, scale, and improve your remediation efforts.

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### 1. Strengthening Your Needs Assessment and Planning

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**Move From Ad Hoc to Structured Data:**

- Use Ally or UDOIT to identify trends across multiple courses.
- Create a shared spreadsheet or dashboard to track remediation volume, file types, and instructor participation.

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**Enhance Your Stakeholder Network:**

- Host a kickoff meeting with academic technology, disability services, and instructional designers.
- Assign roles for outreach, faculty support, remediation, and data tracking.

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**Prioritize Based on Shared Criteria:**

- Use enrollment size, student accommodation requests, and course type to prioritize requests.
- Pilot with high-impact courses and refine your prioritization rubric.



## 2. Expanding Communication and Faculty Engagement

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### Coordinate Targeted Outreach:

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- Work with deans, department chairs, and faculty development offices to identify key instructors.
- Use campaign-style messaging: announcement, reminder, follow-up.

### Launch Q&A Sessions and Office Hours:

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- Offer brief Q&A or office hour sessions in partnership with instructional design.
- Create or localize faculty guides on how to prepare courses for remediation.

### Encourage Self-Remediation Where Feasible:

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- Provide a checklist for faculty: alt text, headings, descriptive links, clear tables.
- Help faculty understand what the central team will handle and what they can do themselves.

## 3. Building and Managing Your Remediation Team

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### Coordinate a Small Remediation Team:

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- Use existing staff, student workers, or interns to start a small but focused team.
- Identify team leads to coordinate daily work and quality assurance.

### Create a Simple Workflow:

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- Set up folders by course in Google Drive or SharePoint.
- Use color-coded spreadsheets or Trello boards to track each course and its remediation status.

### Train Your Team in Phases:

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- Use Equidox, Adobe Acrobat, and WebAIM resources for training.
- Start with Word and PowerPoint remediation, then scale to PDFs and video.

## 4. Managing the Course Remediation Process

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### Refine Your Request Form:

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- Include course name, link, faculty contact info, type of course, and desired return date.
- Make it clear who qualifies and what to expect.

### Standardize Canvas Prep and Cleanup:

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- Work with LMS Admin to duplicate Canvas courses.
- Run TidyUP and collect Ally scores before remediation begins.



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**Organize Content by Type:**

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- Break up remediation by content type: PDFs, videos, documents.
- Assign batches of work to appropriate team members.

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**Track and Return Remediated Courses:**

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- Develop a checklist for completed work.
- Create an email template to explain the improvements and link to resources.

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## 5. Handling On-Demand and Urgent Requests

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**Create a Parallel Process for Urgent Files:**

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- Accept small batches of urgent files via a dedicated form.
- Commit to turnaround times (e.g., 2-3 business days).

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**Triage Complex Requests:**

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- Escalate STEM-heavy or multimedia requests to experienced staff or vendors.
- Log time spent to help with future planning and staffing.

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## 6. Monitoring Your Impact and Improving Over Time

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**Track Your Key Metrics:**

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- Number of courses remediated
- Types of files remediated (PDFs, docs, videos)
- Student hours used
- Faculty engagement

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**Report Out Regularly:**

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- Share progress each semester with your supervisor or committee.
- Highlight success stories and patterns.

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**Build Toward Sustainability:**

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- Document your workflow so others can replicate it.
- Prepare to scale efforts through automation, formalized training, and policy alignment.

The intermediate level is where accessibility becomes a consistent, organized service at your institution. You are now managing people, systems, and partnerships—and preparing your campus to transition into a sustainable, proactive accessibility model.

Advanced:



# Advanced Guide to Implementing the Digital Content Remediation Framework

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This guide is for advanced users—staff already familiar with accessibility principles—who are tasked with managing, scaling, and optimizing the implementation of the Digital Content Remediation Framework. It emphasizes strategic leadership, cross-unit coordination, vendor and data integration, and long-term sustainability. Use it to evolve your efforts into a mature, campus-wide accessibility ecosystem.

## 1. Strategic Needs Assessment & Prioritization

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### Systematize Your Baseline Assessment:

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- Implement automated LMS data pulls (Ally, UDOIT, Canvas APIs) to monitor course content types and compliance scores.
- Map longitudinal data across terms to identify persistent content issues and departments needing support.

### Institutionalize Stakeholder Structures:

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- Maintain an Accessibility Steering Committee with rotating representation.
- Ensure each academic college has a designated liaison for digital accessibility planning.

### Refine Prioritization Frameworks:

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- Apply scoring rubrics based on course modality, enrollment, accommodation requests, and historical risk.
- Use Power BI or Tableau to visualize high-need course clusters and track resolution rates.

## 2. Communication at Scale

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### Sustain a Multi-Tier Messaging Plan:

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- Operationalize quarterly accessibility updates from executive sponsors.
- Equip deans, chairs, and faculty champions with toolkits to conduct localized outreach.

### Data-Informed Messaging:

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- Leverage disaggregated LMS report data to tailor messages by department or course-level engagement.
- Highlight improvements in accessibility scores and use dashboards to prompt proactive participation.



### 3. Expanding Capacity and Continuity

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#### **Institutionalize Student Workforce Pipelines:**

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- Develop formal onboarding and micro-credentialing pathways for student assistants.
- Assign senior student workers as peer mentors; maintain a “bench” of pre-trained candidates each term.

#### **Create a Sustainability Plan:**

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- Cross-train staff in disability services, instructional design, and IT on remediation workflows.
- Codify SOPs and knowledge bases to reduce reliance on single individuals or ad-hoc processes.

#### **Formalize Vendor Engagement:**

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- Use CSU-wide agreements strategically—document decision trees for vendor escalation based on complexity, volume, or urgency.
- Integrate vendor dashboards and APIs (e.g., Allyant) into task tracking systems.

### 4. Advanced Workflow and Automation

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#### **Optimize Canvas Remediation Pipelines:**

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- Build workflows in platforms like Jira or ServiceNow to automate intake, triage, routing, and notifications.
- Standardize course duplication, access provisioning, and post-remediation archiving using Canvas APIs and sub-account permissions.

#### **Incorporate QA and Documentation Stages:**

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- Embed quality assurance checks (e.g., peer audits, random sampling) into each workflow stage.
- Auto-generate accessibility improvement reports to accompany returned courses.

### 5. Responsive On-Demand Support Infrastructure

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#### **Tier Support Models:**

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- Differentiate between standard, expedited, and critical service levels for on-demand requests.
- Establish SLAs with clear turnaround times and escalation protocols.

#### **Advanced File Triage:**

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- Create intake forms that collect metadata (file type, urgency, content type) and route requests via conditional logic.
- Auto-flag STEM-heavy, media-heavy, or complex layout content for specialist review.



## 6. Monitoring, Metrics, and Continuous Improvement

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### Launch Role-Specific Dashboards:

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- Admin dashboards: KPIs on course volume, remediation velocity, content type breakdown, vendor throughput.
- Faculty dashboards: real-time course scores, unresolved issues, self-remediation tips.

### Feedback and Reporting Loops:

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- Implement ticket closure surveys for instructors.
- Schedule quarterly remediation review meetings with leadership to refine tactics.

### SMART KPI System:

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- Define monthly targets by modality, course tier, and remediation type.
- Track student labor utilization, training hours, and cost avoidance metrics.

## 7. Driving Long-Term Accessibility Culture

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### Integrate Accessibility into Instructional Design:

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- Embed remediation into curriculum redesign projects and online course development.
- Require accessibility sign-off for new blueprint/model courses.

### Policy and Compliance Alignment:

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- Align remediation strategy with campus DEI, Universal Design for Learning (UDL), and risk management initiatives.
- Develop policy language to institutionalize digital accessibility expectations.

This advanced guide supports leaders evolving beyond checklists to scalable systems. You are not just implementing a framework—you are transforming how your campus designs, delivers, and maintains equitable digital learning environments.

# Appendix A: Memo: Renewed Campus Commitment: Accessible Technology Initiative (ATI)

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DATE: October 30, 2024  
TO: Faculty and Staff  
FROM: Berenecea Johnson Eanes, President  
SUBJECT: Renewed Campus Commitment: Accessible Technology Initiative (ATI)

Cal State LA is committed to ensuring the success and upward mobility of our students. With the goal of advancing diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging (DEIB) in our university, we strive to nurture a welcoming and inclusive campus where students, faculty, and staff thrive, and community is honored and cultivated.

To fully meet our DEIB goals, we must ensure our technology and information are accessible to all. The technology we use and the information we create must be accessible to our fellow community members with disabilities and those who may learn differently. Accessibility is an equity issue.

Accessibility is also law. Required by the federal government<sup>1</sup> and the state of California<sup>2</sup> (as well as CSU [Executive Order 1111](#) and [Accessible Technology Initiative Policy](#)), all campus programs, services, and activities must be accessible to every student, staff, faculty member—as well as the public. This includes technology products used to deliver academic programs and services, student services, information technology services, and auxiliary programs and services. Recent U.S. Department of Justice final rulemaking on accessibility under Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act sets a definitive date of April 24, 2026, for campus compliance.

Since 2007, the campus has engaged in the Accessible Technology Initiative (ATI). Guided by the ATI Steering Committee, as well as three working groups, Cal State LA established three priority areas:

- Web accessibility
- Accessible electronic and information technology procurement
- Instructional material accessibility

Over the past few years, the ATI process has evolved to advance accessibility in significant new ways. We successfully implemented Canvas as our new learning management system (LMS), with improved accessibility and usability. A revised *Information or Communication Technology Purchase Approval Process* holds vendors to high standards, ensuring the accessibility of hardware and software. Our university website has undergone substantial enhancements, aligning with web accessibility standards. New digital files and media services enhance instructional materials and video content with accessibility features such as closed captions. This work is to be commended.

This year, we launched the Accessible Instructional Materials (AIM) for Student Success Initiative. The AIM campaign offers comprehensive support for instructional materials while recognizing the efforts of faculty and staff Accessible All-Stars. The Academic Senate also passed, and I signed, a revised version of the Accessible Instructional Materials policy, clarifying the shared responsibility among faculty, staff, and administration to ensure our materials are accessible.

As we embark on AY 24-25 together, let us renew our shared commitment to web, procurement, and instructional materials accessibility by setting the following ATI goals:

To all who work on our university website, including staff members in departments and colleges,

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Academic Affairs, Student Affairs, and ITS, I challenge you to renew your commitment to web accessibility. This coming year, work towards:

- Continuing to identify, repair, or replace inaccessible webpages and sites.
- Ensuring any new website or application is accessible.
- Continuing to train our campus community on web accessibility standards, raising awareness of its importance.

To all involved in purchasing or approving technology, including staff members in Administration and Finance, and ITS, I challenge you to renew your commitment to procurement accessibility. This coming year, work towards:

- Ensuring the campus continues to follow our *Information or Communication Technology Purchase Approval Process*.
- Training and conducting outreach for all ICT procurement stakeholders, emphasizing the importance of accessible products and services.
- Sharing resources and learning from other campuses about streamlined and efficient procurement processes.

To all faculty, department and college leaders, staff members in Academic Affairs, Student Affairs, and ITS, I challenge you to renew your commitment to instructional material accessibility. This coming year, work towards:

- Making timely adoption decisions for instructional materials, selecting, and curating materials with accessibility in mind.
- Selecting and using accessible multimedia, interactive content, and emerging technologies.
- Continuing to use Canvas LMS to share accessible instructional materials with students.
- Taking advantage of help, support, and services to make instructional materials accessible.
- Monitoring and acting when materials are not accessible.
- Seeking out ways to design courses in support of universal design for learning principles.

I challenge you to become an [Accessible All-Star](#). Make accessibility part of your daily routine. Help our campus meet these ambitious accessibility goals. Together, we can create an inclusive learning environment for all students. Thank you for your contributions in making Cal State LA equitable for all.





## Appendix B: Executive-Level Campus Wide Communication

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Dear Faculty,

I'm excited to share a new Academic Affairs initiative: [AIM for Student Success](#).

Faculty Affairs, CETL, the University Library, and ITS Universal Design Services have partnered to offer you an easy to use, no-cost service to make your digital instructional materials accessible. With the click of a button, you may request accessible instructional material support for your Canvas course content. Digital files are made accessible so that all students have equal access to instructional materials.

### **How does this new service work?**

To ensure our initiative has the greatest impact, we are prioritizing Fall 2024 courses where a student has requested an accessible media accommodation.

In the next few weeks, you may receive a notification email if you're scheduled to teach one of the priority courses. Please carefully follow the email instructions so that our colleagues in ITS, the Library, and CETL can work to make your instructional materials accessible.

### **Why is this initiative important?**

Accessible instructional materials are key to enacting the University's mission of promoting a culture of diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging. By ensuring your materials are accessible, you help promote DEIB within your teaching, and create an equitable learning environment that benefits all students.

### **What are some examples of accessible instructional materials?**

As you teach your course, you may use PowerPoints, Word documents, PDFs, and instructional videos. These materials can be made more accessible by providing all students multiple means of representing the content, such as images with text-based descriptions (alt-text), videos with accurate closed captioning, and readable PDFs.

### **Become an Accessible All-Star - Celebrate Your Commitment to Equity**

When you make your digital files accessible, you show your commitment to promoting diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging in your teaching to benefit all students. This makes you an [Accessible All-Star](#)!

Your efforts will be recognized on the [AIM for Student Success Showcase page](#). We encourage you to visit the showcase, learn more about the initiative, and see your colleagues who have already become Accessible All-Stars.

### **What if I'm not teaching a prioritized course?**

If you do not receive an email notification, you can still be part of our [AIM for Student Success Initiative](#). Learn more about the AIM for Student Success Initiative and how you can get involved.

Please send your questions to [CETL@calstatela.edu](mailto:CETL@calstatela.edu).

Amy Bippus  
Interim Provost and Vice President for Academic Affairs



## Appendix C: College-Level Communication

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Dear Faculty,

I hope you saw Dr. Bippus' message announcing AIM for Student Success. In the next few weeks, you may receive an email notification offering a service to make your instructional materials more accessible. If you receive this message, it means a student in your fall course has requested an accessible media accommodation.

Please take advantage of this new service. Our colleagues in CETL, the University Library, and ITS Universal Design Services are eager to help you. You need only submit a short request form. Simply complete the form indicating which Canvas course contains content you plan to use again this coming fall semester.

Digital files and content within the Canvas course will be made accessible. Later in August, as you get ready to teach your fall course, you can transfer the accessible course content into your Fall 2024 Semester course shell.

Notification emails will go out in waves, as more students register for classes and also request an OSD accommodation.

If you do not receive an email notification by the end of the term, you can still be part of the [AIM for Student Success Initiative](#). Learn more about the AIM for Student Success Initiative and how you can get involved, including attending the [90-minute CETL webinar on accessible instructional materials](#).

Should you have questions about AIM for Students Success, please email our colleagues in CETL, [CETL@calstatela.edu](mailto:CETL@calstatela.edu).

[College Dean]



Dear Faculty,

Last week, you received an email notification offering a service to make your instructional materials more accessible. You received this message because a student in your fall course has requested an accessible media accommodation.

Please take advantage of this new service. Locate the email notification, as it contains a customized link to the online request form. If you did not receive the email notification, please contact our CETL colleagues at [CETL@calstatela.edu](mailto:CETL@calstatela.edu). CETL, the University Library, and ITS Universal Design Services are eager to help you.

Digital files and content within a Canvas course will be made accessible. Later in August, as you get ready to teach your fall course, you can transfer the accessible course content into your Fall 2024 semester course shell.

If you already completed the online form, thank you! This is an important first step to better ensure your future student's success. Learn more about the [AIM for Student Success Initiative](#).

[College Dean]



# Appendix D: Communication Toolkits for Chairs and Deans

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## What is the AIM for Student Success Initiative?

ITS Universal Design Services, the University Library, and CETL have partnered to offer faculty an **easy to use, no-cost service** to make their digital instructional materials accessible. With the click of a button, faculty may request accessible instructional material support for their Canvas course content. Digital files are made accessible so that all students have equal access to course instructional materials—fundamental for student success.

## Why is this initiative important?

Accessible instructional materials are key to enacting the University's mission of promoting a culture of equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging. By ensuring their materials are accessible, faculty help promote EDIB within their teaching, and create an equitable learning environment that benefits all students.

## What are some examples of accessible instructional materials?

As they teach, faculty may use PowerPoints, Word documents, PDFs, and instructional videos. These materials can be made more accessible by providing all students multiple means of representing the content, such as images with text-based descriptions (alt-text), videos with accurate closed captioning, and readable PDFs.

## How does the process work?

All faculty can be part of our AIM for Student Success Initiative. Encourage your faculty to:

- Learn more about the [AIM for Student Success Initiative](#).
- Request support for a smaller batch of files anytime using the [Single Document Remediation Request](#) form.
- Sign up for the [Accessible Instructional Materials](#) webinar.
- Learn more about the [Ally Accessibility](#) report inside their Canvas course.
- Share this information with colleagues and engage in conversation on the benefits of accessible instructional materials.

## How do we raise this issue at a department meeting?

Below are email templates for communication you can send to your faculty.

Email to Include the AIM Initiative as a Department Meeting Agenda Item

Dear (faculty),

Providing students with an accessible learning environment is important for ensuring equity and student success in our Department. The new AIM for Student Success Initiative supports you in making your course instructional materials accessible, and the service is **no-cost and easy-to-use**.

At our upcoming Department Meeting, I want to review this initiative with you and think about how we can best utilize the service in our Department. In preparation for our meeting, please do the following:

- Visit the [AIM for Student Success webpage](#)
- Access the Enhancing Accessibility for Student Success handout
- Help us create an implementation plan by:
  - Identifying courses that you regularly teach over multiple semesters.
  - Identifying any regularly shared course materials you use with your colleagues. For example, a digital textbook or publisher PPTs that you use in multiple courses.



### Email to Acknowledge Accessible All-Stars

Dear (faculty),

Congratulations on becoming an Accessible All-Star! By taking advantage of the Accessible Instructional Materials for Student Success service, you have demonstrated a commitment to diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging at Cal State LA. Providing an equitable and accessible learning environment for all students will make a significant impact in our Department and on our campus.

I hope you will share your success with your colleagues, include this achievement in your RTP dossier, and tell your colleagues about this initiative so that they will also use the service. Thank you for committing to our students and becoming an Accessible All-Star.

### How do we promote equity and recognize faculty who make a commitment?

When faculty make their digital files accessible, they show their commitment to promoting equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging in their teaching to benefit all students. This makes them [Accessible All-Stars](#)! This will be one of several measures of our initiative's success.

Faculty who complete their course remediation will be recognized on our website Showcase page, will receive a digital badge, and will be encouraged to include their achievement in their RTP dossier. We encourage you to visit this website, learn more about the initiative, and see current faculty who have become Accessible All-Stars.

### What's the best way to approach AIM for Student Success in our department?

We recommend doing the following to best utilize this ongoing service:

- Advertise the service to your faculty at the start and end of each semester. You can send the included email.
- Encourage your faculty to visit the [Accessible All-Stars initiative](#) website.
- Celebrate faculty in your Department who become Accessible All-Stars. Consider recognizing these faculty in Department meetings or through department-wide communication.

### What resources are available to the department?

- [AIM for Student Success webpage](https://www.calstatela.edu/cetl/aim-student-success)  
<https://www.calstatela.edu/cetl/aim-student-success>

### Thank You!

Your assistance in this process is greatly appreciated. Thank you for helping to promote accessibility, diversity, equity, inclusion, and belonging for student success.



### What is the AIM for Student Success Initiative?

ITS Universal Design Services, the University Library, and CETL have partnered to offer faculty an **easy to use, no-cost service** to make their digital instructional materials accessible. With the click of a button, faculty may request accessible instructional material support for their Canvas course content. Digital files are made accessible so that all students have equal access to course instructional materials—fundamental for student success.

### How are courses prioritized for Fall 2024 remediation?

To ensure our initiative has the greatest impact, we are prioritizing **Fall 2024 courses where a student has requested an accessible media accommodation**. Faculty will receive a notification email if they are scheduled to teach one of these priority courses.

### How does the process work?

Faculty teaching a prioritized course will be directly contacted and asked to submit a remediation request form.

How it works:

1. Faculty will receive a notification email containing a link to the request form.
  - a. Please note: request form links are personalized for each faculty. Sharing of request form links is discouraged.
2. CETL staff will make a copy of their Canvas course.
3. ITS staff will work in this copied course to inventory and make files accessible.
4. Faculty will use the remediated version of the course when they teach in Fall 2024.

### What emails will be sent to Faculty?

All faculty will receive the Provost's announcement of AIM for Student Success. Faculty teaching a prioritized course will receive three notification emails in the coming weeks. **Templates for emails the college should send will be provided to you.**

1. Announcing AIM for Student Success (Week of April 15)
  - a. Sent by the Provost's Office
  - b. What is it: an introduction to the initiative.
2. Direct Faculty Outreach to Initiate Remediation (Notification #1) (Week of April 29)
  - a. Sent by the Office of Faculty Affairs and the Office for Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Belonging.
  - b. What is it: faculty's first notice **that a student in their fall course has requested an accessible media accommodation**. Faculty provided link to request course remediation service.
3. Follow Up by **College Deans** (Notification #2) **(Week of May 6)**
  - a. Sent by College Deans.
  - b. What is it: a follow-up email to Faculty who have received Notification #1.
4. Final Follow-Up by **College Deans** (Notification #3) **(Week of May 20)**
  - a. Sent by College Deans.
  - b. What is it: a final notification to faculty who have not yet initiated digital file remediation services.

### Which faculty should receive these notification emails?

For notification emails #2 and #3, CETL will send the college a mailing list and a suggested email template.

### Why is this initiative important?

Accessible instructional materials are key to enacting the University's mission of promoting a culture of equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging. By ensuring their materials are accessible, faculty help



promote EDIB within their teaching, and create an equitable learning environment that benefits all students.

**What are some examples of accessible instructional materials?**

As they teach, faculty may use PowerPoints, Word documents, PDFs, and instructional videos. These materials can be made more accessible by providing all students multiple means of representing the content, such as images with text-based descriptions (alt-text), videos with accurate closed captioning, and readable PDFs.

**How do we promote equity and recognize faculty who make a commitment?**

When faculty make their digital files accessible, they show their commitment to promoting equity, diversity, inclusion, and belonging in their teaching to benefit all students. This makes them [Accessible All-Stars](#)! This will be one of several measures of our initiative's success.

Faculty who complete their course remediation will be recognized on our website Showcase page, will receive a digital badge, and will be encouraged to include their achievement in their RTP dossier. We encourage you to visit this website, learn more about the initiative, and see current faculty who have become Accessible All-Stars.

**What resources are available to the college?**

- AIM for Student Success SharePoint Site
- Academic Affairs ATI IM Procedure
- [AIM for Student Success webpage](#)
- Priority Course Remediation – College-Level Reports



## Appendix E: Faculty Outreach Message with Request Form

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Dear [FIRST NAME],

This coming [TERM] semester, one of your students in [COURSE] requested an accessible media accommodation (through the Office of Students with Disabilities).

Ensure your student can access your instructional materials. Use the new [Canvas Course Remediation service](#) that makes digital files in your course fully accessible.

We understand that your [TERM] course may not be ready yet. You can still use this service. Simply provide a link to a past course that contains the same or much of the same content you plan to use in the upcoming semester.

This service is free to you—all you need to do is give us your consent to make your instructional materials accessible. [Submit the online form](#) as soon as possible to request this service.

Accessible materials help ALL students, but are required when a student requests an accommodation. Support your students and become an [Accessible All-Star!](#)

What are some examples of accessible instructional materials?

You might use PowerPoints, Word documents, PDFs, and instructional videos. These materials can be made more accessible by providing students multiple means of representing the content, such as images with text-based descriptions (alt-text), videos with accurate closed captioning, and readable PDFs.

ITS Universal Design Services, the University Library, and CETL will work together to ensure your materials are accessible.

Become an Accessible All-Star!

When you make your materials accessible, you show your commitment to equitable learning. This makes you an Accessible All-Star! You will be recognized as an Accessible All-Star on our website. Include this achievement in RTP or PAF file. Your Department Chair, Dean, and Associate Dean will be notified of your achievement.

What are your next steps?

[Submit the online form](#) to request the Canvas Course Remediation service.

Please also refer to the [OSD Notification of Academic Support Services message](#) for complete details on the requested accommodation. Consider reviewing our [AIM for Student Success FAQ section](#) for additional information and to attend an information session. Let us know what questions you have; we're eager to gather feedback on this new service. Please send feedback to [cetl@calstatela.edu](mailto:cetl@calstatela.edu)

-The AIM for Student Success Team





## Appendix F: Email Notification for Completion of Service

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Dear [FIRST NAME],

Thank you for your patience as we worked to improve the accessibility of your course materials. The course [COURSE NAME] is now ready! An accessible copy of your course is available here: [COURSE LINK].

To make this version available to your students, import the accessible copy into your fall Canvas course. Visit [Importing and Migrating Courses](#) for step-by-step instructions. Should you need assistance, please visit [CETL Support Services](#).

As you get ready for fall semester, you may need to upload additional files and create new materials. Visit [How to Make New Content Accessible](#) to review best practices for ensuring new content is accessible as it's created.

Visit [Instructional Material Support for Existing Content](#) to submit a new remediation request.

You may wish to monitor the accessibility score of your course, comparing the accessible course score to the previous inaccessible version.

Visit [How do I see my Canvas course Ally Accessibility Report?](#) to review steps for activating the course level accessibility report.

Last, we've add you to our [AIM for Student Success Showcase](#). You're now an Accessible All-Star! We appreciate your participation in this important initiative. Your commitment to creating an inclusive and equitable learning environment makes a significant difference in the lives of our students. Thank you!

-The CETL Team

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